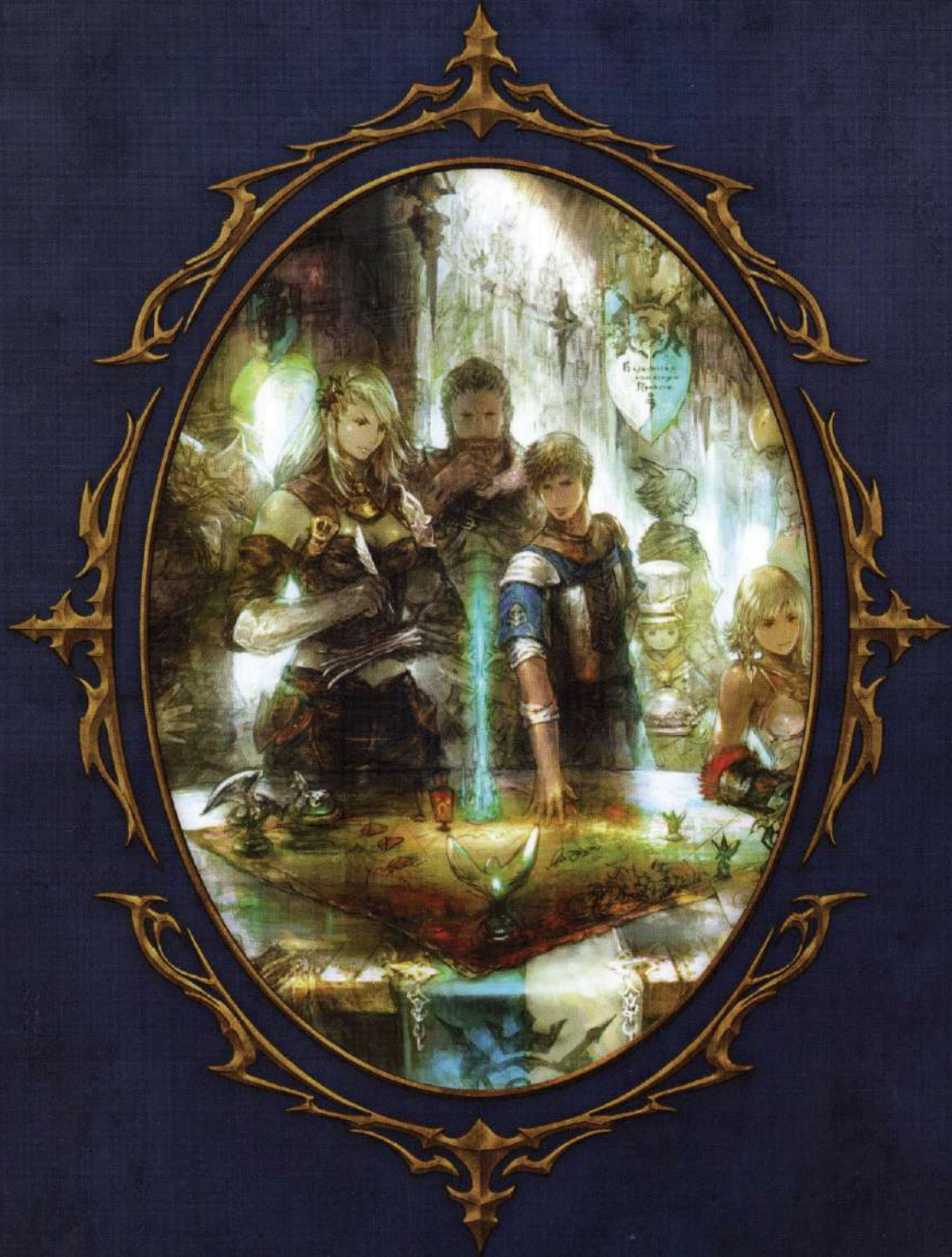


FINAL FANTASY XIV TTRPG
STARTER SET



GAMEMASTER BOOK

GAMEMASTER BOOK TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER 3: RUNNING THE GAME	4	Playing the Game	10
Choosing a Gamemaster	4	Quicksaving	10
Gathering Your Party	4	Additional Rules and Considerations	11
What If I Don't Have a Rulebook?	5	Using Items	11
Choosing a Game Day	5	Placing Markers	11
What if I Can't Find Enough Players?	5	CHAPTER 4: ADVENTURING	12
Companions	6	Roleplaying Basics	13
Companion: Defender	6	Making Checks Outside of Encounters	14
Companion: Healer	7	Making Multiple Checks	15
Companion: Attacker	7	Awarding Advantage Dice	15
Preparing for the Game	8	GM Discretion	15
Laying the Groundwork	8	The Passage of Time	16
Reviewing the Scenario	8	One Action = One Bell	16
Going Beyond the Starter Set	9	Adjusting Time Frames	16
Your First Game Session	9	Delegating Actions	16
Making Introductions	9	Encounters and the Passage of Time	16
		Travel	17
		Rest and Sleep	17
		Rest	17
		Sleep	17



Pages 18 to 61 contain playable game scenarios. To avoid spoiling the story, they should only be read by the GM.

SCENARIO 1: THE CRYSTAL CAPER	18
SCENARIO 2: IMPERIAL MACHINATIONS	30
SCENARIO 3: HEROES OF OPERATION ARCHON	46
CHAPTER 5: CONTINUING THE STORY	62
Finishing a Scenario.....	62
Handling Party Defeat	62
Downtime Between Adventures.....	63
Confidence Makes the GM	63
FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS	64

Symbols and Formatting in This Book

Bolded Blue Text: Primary and Secondary Attributes

Bolded Red Text: Ability Names

[]: Steps and Timing

Italics: Dialogue and Ability Type

Bold: Enhancements, Enfeeblements, and Traits

: Scenario Text to Read Aloud

: GM Only Scenario Information

: Enemy *Invoked* Ability





CHAPTER 3: RUNNING THE GAME

If you've never played a tabletop roleplaying game before, you probably have countless questions about how it actually works, especially if you're the GM. Don't worry—this chapter will walk you through all the steps needed for running your very first game.

Keep in mind that there is nothing wrong with choosing to do something your own way. There are as many GM styles as there are stars in the sky, and all of them are equally valid. As the GM, **your job is to make sure everyone at the table is enjoying themselves**, and you have the power to bend the rules and alter the scenario to ensure that happens.

Choosing a Gamemaster

Is your group missing a GM? If so, perhaps you should consider taking up the gamemaster's mantle for yourself. The fact that you've started reading this chapter means you're more than qualified for the job.

Facilitating the game might seem daunting to a new player, but don't worry—in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, **being the GM is much easier than you might imagine.**

As the other players control adventurers traveling the land of Eorzea, they have to rely on their imagination and instincts to overcome each new encounter and situation they face. The GM, on the other hand, can simply read aloud from the scenario and follow its instructions when controlling enemies.

Even if you do make a mistake during an encounter, chances are the players will just assume that an enemy let their guard down. And what could be more exciting for them than an opportunity to try something daring and dramatic?

What's more, playing as the GM means you'll be privy to secrets the other players may never uncover. While reading a scenario, you'll learn the different ways the story can unfold and find out what machinations are in motion behind the scenes—an exciting prospect, considering that scenarios can tie into the main scenario of Final Fantasy XIV!

So, what do you say? Become a GM today!

If another player has volunteered to GM your game, be sure to lend them the Starter Set well in advance. They will need time to prepare; if you hand them this book the day of your first session, it will make it very difficult for them to run an enjoyable game.



GATHERING YOUR PARTY

The Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG is designed for a group of five players: four adventurers and one GM. As such, your first order of business will be finding a group to join you on your quest.

Start by asking a friend who you think would enjoy the game. If they agree to join your group, ask them to help you find three more players. This game is meant to be enjoyed with others, so you don't need to prepare for it alone.

Considerations for a New Group

Remote or Local Play

You'll need to decide whether you want to play in-person or online. If you choose to play online, you have the option of inviting friends who don't live nearby to participate.

Setting Expectations

If this is your first time running the game, let the other players know that you'll be learning as you go. In-person groups can often help you understand any rules you're unsure about, so feel free to pass the rulebook around the table for a group discussion if you get stuck. Online groups can refer to an abbreviated version of the official rules here to do much the same: <https://www.square-enix-shop.com/ffxivttrpg/>

Having Fun

Make sure everyone knows the game isn't about winning or losing. Rather, it's about collaborating with your friends to create an exciting and unique story, and more than anything else, it's about having fun!

Time

Be up-front about the time commitment. It can take upwards of four or five hours to finish a scenario. Of course, you don't have to play it all in a single sitting. This game also allows for quicksaving (see page 10) so you can split up a scenario into more manageable sessions. If your players are busy, you might try scheduling short sessions in the evening after school or work.

WARNING! Pages 18 through 61 contain an original set of scenarios exclusive to the Starter Set. If you intend to participate in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG as an adventurer and not a GM, do **NOT** read those pages, as they contain **massive spoilers** for the story ahead.

What If I Don't Have a Rulebook?

You might be wondering if you need to own the rulebook to play the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG. Having your own individual copy can come in handy, but it's not strictly required. So long as your group has a way to reference the official rules, be that a print copy of the rulebook or the abbreviated version online, you'll have no trouble playing the game.

Be aware, however, that you cannot substitute unofficial rule compendiums or fan-made summaries for the official rulebook if you intend to enjoy this game as it was designed. In order to ensure fair play, you will need an official copy of the rules.

This is not to say that you should avoid fan-made materials entirely. Rule summaries created by passionate players can help streamline gameplay and make your life as a GM much easier. Even so, any time you're uncertain about a rule, referring to an official source will ensure the game is being played fairly and to the standard to which it was designed.

CHOOSING A GAME DAY

Once you've found a group, it's time to pick a day to play. As the game involves a lot of conversation and cooperative problem-solving, there's no way to tell just how long it will take your group to complete your chosen scenario. Even so, you should set a start and end time for the session that works for everyone.

On the day of your game, if your end time is closing in and you still haven't finished the scenario, you can always quicksave (see page 10) and continue the story at a later date.

What If I Can't Find Enough Players?

The majority of this game's scenarios are designed for a light party—that is, a group of four adventurers—plus the GM.

Unfortunately, it's not always easy to find four other players. Even if you do, scheduling can be a tricky beast, and there's always the chance someone will have to cancel at the last minute.

That doesn't mean your game day plans are a wash. The Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG has a set of rules for introducing companions that can fill out a party's roster whenever you find yourself short on players.

Keep in mind that the Starter Set's scenarios were designed for groups of five players, so you may not get the most out of them if you've only managed to find one other player. If this is the case, it is recommended that you continue looking for additional players to join your group.



COMPANIONS

Companions are special NPCs that accompany the adventurers during a scenario. Unlike other NPCs, which are handled by the GM, players take control of their companions during encounters. Companions are capable of performing any of the actions an adventurer can, with one important exception: they cannot use limit breaks.

The GM is free to give companions personalities or allow them to aid the adventurers outside of encounters. Alternatively, they can opt to rule that companions cannot affect the world around them—much like FFXIV's chocobo companions—to avoid taking the focus away from the player characters.

If, for example, the adventurers need to make **DEX** checks to hide, no check is required for their companions. If the entire party succeeds, their companions manage to hide as well. If a member of the party fails, their companions fail along with them.

Like adventurers, every companion has a role. Defenders soak up damage and keep enemies busy, allowing them to stand in for tanks. Attackers specialize in dealing damage, while healers keep the party fighting fit; as such, they can fill the boots of missing DPS or healer adventurers, respectively.

By using companions to fill the vacant roles in the party, your group can take on scenarios meant for light parties even when you are short on players.

As players will need to remember the rules for their companions, a single player should be responsible for no more than one companion at a time. If there are several companions traveling with the party, decide ahead of time which players will control them during encounters.

Using companions will often make the scenario somewhat more challenging for the players, so make sure your group is aware of this beforehand. When running a game for a single player, you'll want to avoid scenarios that are intended for a light party, or find more players to fill out your ranks.



DEFENDER

CHOCOBO COMPANION: DEFENDER (LEVEL 30)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 13

Defense: 14		Magic Defense: 14		
Max HP: 40		Speed: 5 squares		
STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+3	+3	+3	+3	+3

Abilities

Choco Strike Primary, Physical

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Deals 2 damage and inflicts **Enmity** on all targets.

Choco Drop Primary, Physical

Target: Up to 2 characters Range: 1 square

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage and inflicts **Enmity** on all targets.

CHOCOBO COMPANION: DEFENDER (LEVEL 40)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 13

Defense: 14		Magic Defense: 14		
Max HP: 50		Speed: 5 squares		
STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+3	+3	+3	+3	+3

Abilities

Choco Strike Primary, Physical

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Deals 2 damage and inflicts **Enmity** on all targets.

Choco Drop Primary, Physical

Target: Up to 2 characters Range: 1 square

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage and inflicts **Enmity** on all targets.

CHOCOBO COMPANION: DEFENDER (LEVEL 50)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 14

Defense: 15		Magic Defense: 15		
Max HP: 60		Speed: 5 squares		
STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+4	+4	+4	+4	+4

Abilities

Choco Strike Primary, Physical

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage and inflicts **Enmity** on all targets.

Choco Drop Primary, Physical

Target: Up to 2 characters Range: 1 square

Base Effect: Deals 7 damage and inflicts **Enmity** on all targets.

**HEALER****CHOCOBO COMPANION: HEALER (LEVEL 30)**

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 13

Defense: 13 Magic Defense: 13
 Max HP: 25 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +3 +3 +3 +3 +3

Abilities**Choco Cure + Choco Esuna** *Primary, Magic*

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Restores 12 HP and removes a single enfeeblement of your choosing from the target. Some enfeeblements cannot be removed by this effect.

Choco Medica *Primary, Magic*

Target: All allies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Restores 7 HP to all targets.

**ATTACKER****CHOCOBO COMPANION: ATTACKER (LEVEL 30)**

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 13

Defense: 13 Magic Defense: 13
 Max HP: 30 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +3 +3 +3 +3 +3

Abilities**Choco Slash** *Primary, Physical*

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Base Effect: Deals 15 damage to the target.

Choco Blast *Primary, Physical*

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Deals 7 damage to all targets.

CHOCOBO COMPANION: HEALER (LEVEL 40)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 13

Defense: 13 Magic Defense: 13
 Max HP: 35 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +3 +3 +3 +3 +3

Abilities**Choco Cure + Choco Esuna** *Primary, Magic*

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Restores 12 HP and removes a single enfeeblement of your choosing from the target. Some enfeeblements cannot be removed by this effect.

Choco Medica *Primary, Magic*

Target: All allies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Restores 7 HP to all targets.

CHOCOBO COMPANION: ATTACKER (LEVEL 40)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 13

Defense: 13 Magic Defense: 13
 Max HP: 40 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +3 +3 +3 +3 +3

Abilities**Choco Slash** *Primary, Physical*

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Base Effect: Deals 15 damage to the target.

Choco Blast *Primary, Physical*

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Deals 7 damage to all targets.

CHOCOBO COMPANION: HEALER (LEVEL 50)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 14

Defense: 14 Magic Defense: 14
 Max HP: 45 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +4 +4 +4 +4 +4

Abilities**Choco Cure + Choco Esuna** *Primary, Magic*

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Restores 21 HP and removes a single enfeeblement of your choosing from the target. Some enfeeblements cannot be removed by this effect.

Choco Medica *Primary, Magic*

Target: All allies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Restores 12 HP to all targets.

CHOCOBO COMPANION: ATTACKER (LEVEL 50)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Cloudkin

Vigilance: 14

Defense: 14 Magic Defense: 14
 Max HP: 50 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +4 +4 +4 +4 +4

Abilities**Choco Slash** *Primary, Physical*

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Base Effect: Deals 22 damage to the target.

Choco Blast *Primary, Physical*

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character

Base Effect: Deals 12 damage to all targets.

PREPARING FOR THE GAME

You'll need a few things to play the game, but don't worry—the key components are included in this Starter Set!

Key Components

- ◆ A scenario (such as the ones found on pages 18 - 61)
- ◆ Adventurer sheets for your players
- ◆ Dice
- ◆ An encounter map
- ◆ Character tokens
- ◆ Markers



You'll also want to have pencils and scrap paper on hand to keep track of HP, MP, and other important information when you're playing in-person. If your group is playing online, each player will need access to a computer, tablet, or smartphone, and a decent internet connection.

Next, you'll need to start preparing for the game itself. If you haven't already, decide which player will be the GM. The GM then needs to choose a scenario for their group to play. If it's your first time playing the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, it would be a good idea to start with the scenario intended for level 30 adventurers.

After you inform your group of the scenario's level, the other players should choose their adventurers. The Starter Set includes adventurer sheets for a warrior, a white mage, a dragoon, and a black mage.

LAYING THE GROUNDWORK

If time allows, find a day for your group to meet prior to your first session so you can familiarize players with their chosen adventurers and help them come up with profiles.

If you wait until your first session to do this, there's a good chance it'll cut into the time you could be spending playing the game. Walking players through the basics of their adventurers' jobs and having them start writing their profiles ahead of time will make your first session go that much smoother.

REVIEWING THE SCENARIO

As the GM, you should make time to review the scenario you will be playing before your first session. We recommend that you use the level 30 scenario on page 18 for your first foray into the world of the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, as it provides a helpful introduction to the basics of gameplay.

There's no need to memorize your scenario word for word, but you want to go into the game with a solid grasp of the scenario's major plot beats and how they come together for its climax. You'll have an easier time running things if you've done your prep work, and the other players will appreciate the time and effort you put into the game.

Once you've read the scenario, you can even log into Final Fantasy XIV to visit the locations in which it takes place. Plus, if the scenario's NPCs are present in-game, you can talk to them to get a better idea of how they're portrayed. This kind of research can be a great way to get inspiration for your game!

Going Beyond the Starter Set

This Starter Set was designed to be easy to play, allowing players to jump in and enjoy premade scenarios using premade adventurers. However, the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG offers a great deal of freedom to those interested in putting their own spin on things.

Players who own the Standard Rulebook can create original adventurers using any of the jobs described within. Not only that, but data for additional adventurer jobs is also planned for future release on the game's official website, which will further expand a player's character options.

Similarly, GMs are free to adjust premade scenarios to add plot twists or new conclusions, or to reference information in the Scenario & Gamemaster Guide to add new and dangerous foes to challenge their players. GMs are also encouraged to create original scenarios from scratch for themselves, once they feel they're ready.

Dealing with Player Conflicts

Lastly, there is one important thing for GMs to consider. You may have players in your group who disagree with the way in which you want to run your game. When conflicts arise, you are encouraged to sit down with players and try to work things out in a manner that leaves everyone satisfied. However, if a player refuses to accept your decision, remind them that the GM has the final say with regards to in-game matters.

Everyone, including the GM, should enjoy their experience playing a game together. If a player feels that abiding by your decisions will keep them from enjoying the game, they should consider looking for another group.

Neither player nor GM are ever obligated to continue playing together if they feel uncomfortable or aren't having fun.

While it can be frustrating to leave a group, finding like-minded players who prefer a similar style of gameplay will allow you to better enjoy your time with this game.

YOUR FIRST GAME SESSION

MAKING INTRODUCTIONS

At last, the day has come to begin your adventure! Once all players have arrived and are seated around your table, begin by having them introduce their adventurers to one another.

You may also want them to come up with an explanation of how their adventurers met and formed their party. Doing so will help them roleplay their characters, lend depth to the story, and establish relationships within the party. There's no need to come up with anything too intricate—it's perfectly acceptable to go around the table and have each player explain how their adventurer knows the adventurer of the player to their left.

This can be as simple as deciding that the warrior is traveling with the dragoon to pay back a debt, that the dragoon and the black mage belong to the same free company, that the black mage is the white mage's elder brother, and that the warrior reminds the white mage of her late father.

Example:

Warrior → Dragoon:

Owes the dragoon a debt

Dragoon → Black Mage:

Belongs to the same free company

Black Mage → White Mage:

The white mage's elder brother

White Mage → Warrior:

Reminds her of her late father

Friendship, debts, mutual goals, rivalries, bonds of respect or those of blood—these are just a few places you can start. As the story progresses, the relationships between adventurers will naturally grow stronger.

All that being said, remember that this part of the game is entirely optional. Many players find determining who their character is to be an insurmountable task for their first session, and prefer to start simply with the mechanical aspects of character creation. Then, they organically develop and explore their character's personality, backstory, and quirks as they adventure and interact with the world around them.

Lastly, if this is your first time running the game, remind the players that you'll be sticking closely to the scenario and may have to refuse any unexpected requests or actions that would interfere with the story.



PLAYING THE GAME

Once the adventurers are acquainted with each other, you're ready to delve into the story! As the GM, it's up to you to describe what the other players see and experience, and determine how their actions affect the world in which they find themselves.

The scenario will act as your guide, providing descriptions and lines of dialogue for you to read aloud. If an adventurer notices something the rest of their party does not, you can whisper something privately to that player or have them read the applicable passage in the scenario.

Because TTRPGs offer players a great deal of freedom, there's no way for the scenario or GM to anticipate every possible course of action the party might take. New GMs might find themselves overwhelmed if a player does something that prevents the story from playing out as the scenario intends. If you don't have much experience running TTRPGs, consider using some of the following strategies to keep your game manageable:

- **After explaining a situation to the adventurers, offer them the choices listed in the scenario instead of asking them what they want to do.**

This will help you avoid unexpected developments and keep the game moving, as the players won't need to spend as much time thinking about what actions their adventurers should take.

- **If a player wants their adventurer to do something so unexpected or outlandish that it would interfere with the events of the scenario, ask them to choose a different action.**

Even if their idea makes perfect sense in context, you can explain that you're not sure how to handle it without throwing the story off course. While it's important to allow players the freedom to think outside the box, their actions shouldn't derail the entire game.

Of course, you're encouraged to permit actions that play into the story the scenario is trying to tell. It's also possible that you might not understand the intent behind an action, so be sure to ask what a player is trying to accomplish before you say no. Ideally, you can take their goal into consideration and suggest an alternative action that works within the confines of the story, but new GMs don't need to worry about this if it proves too challenging.

- **If you're not sure how best to handle a situation, ask the other players for advice.**

Don't be afraid to show them the scenario if you have to; it's far better to spoil a plot beat or two than risk leading the party astray. The same is true when you notice the players are overlooking something important. Everyone will have more fun if you gently guide them back to the story instead of letting them make the same mistake over and over without getting anywhere.

- **Don't be afraid to change the rules.**

If something isn't working, or you can't find a rule when you need it, you can always make something up on the fly. When playing a TTRPG, what the GM says goes, **even if the rules disagree**. There's nothing wrong with asking your group for advice, but once you've made a decision, be confident in it. You're the one running the game, after all.

This doesn't mean that you have the right to make arbitrary decisions to amuse yourself at the expense of the other players. Never forget that your powers exist to ensure your group is having fun as you guide them through the story.

- **If you realize you've made a mistake, just keep going.**

You might make a ruling during the game, only to find that you were wrong when you check the rulebook an hour later. Mistakes happen, but trying to go back to fix them can often make things worse.

If you realize you've gotten something wrong, it's up to you to decide if you want to follow the official rules going forward or stick to the way you've been playing.

However, be sure to let your players know when making a course correction and changing the rules. There's nothing wrong with admitting that you've made a mistake, and explaining any rule adjustments you need to make will prevent confusion and help keep everyone on the same page.

QUICKSAVING

As your group becomes invested in the events unfolding in your game, you may find certain parts of the scenario take longer than you anticipated. If it looks like you won't be able to finish in the time you have remaining, you should look for a good stopping place to quicksave.

Saving the game is as simple as marking down how far you got in the scenario and recording the party's status, including current HP, MP, and other relevant info. You'll want to do the same for any NPCs who will make an appearance in future sessions.

Keeping accurate records will let you pick things up from where you left off the next time you play. Be sure to check with the other players when resuming your game to make sure you're not forgetting anything.

If you have to quicksave in the middle of an encounter, you'll need to record the positions of each character on the encounter map. You could add this info to your other quicksave notes, but taking a photo or screenshot would work just as well. Some online gaming tools even allow you to save a copy of the map so you don't have to set up again next time.

Remember, never feel pressured to finish an entire scenario in a single session. While some groups prefer to set aside an entire day to play through a long scenario, others would rather break it into several shorter sessions. Speak with your group to decide which approach works best for you.

ADDITIONAL RULES AND CONSIDERATIONS

Linkpearls

Linkpearls are useful devices that allow adventurers to communicate across vast distances. As such, player characters are free to use their linkpearls to speak with other party members when separated, or to contact NPCs they're acquainted with should the need arise.

Of course, this assumes the adventurer and the character they want to contact are in a position to have a conversation. The GM will decide if linkpearls can be used in a given situation.

Teleporting

It's common knowledge that adventurers are able to teleport to aetherytes they've previously attuned to. As the player characters have some measure of adventuring experience under their belts, it's safe to assume they've already attuned to the aetherytes found in Eorzea's major city-states—unless, of course, a player has opted to play a particularly sheltered or naive adventurer.

While playing the scenarios included in the Starter Set, adventurers may teleport to any aetherytes in and around the region in which the story is set.

See the section on travel on page 17 for more information on teleportation.

Gil and Items

Owing to their previous adventures, the player characters should have enough gil to get by—assuming a player hasn't chosen to play as an adventurer who is always strapped for coin. As such, you don't have to keep a running tally of the party's finances. You can simply assume the adventurers are paying for goods and services with the gil they have on hand.

Some items, however, cannot be purchased with gil alone, and instead require other forms of currency. The rules for buying and selling such items can be found in the Standard Rulebook.

USING ITEMS

While playing through the scenarios included in the Starter Set, the adventurers will come into possession of a number of useful items. The majority of these items are consumables, which are discarded after use.

Like abilities, items can be used as primary or secondary actions, depending on their type. A character can use any number of items during a single encounter, provided the item is in their inventory.

If an encounter has multiple phases, each adventurer may use one of their items at the end of a phase, before a new one begins.

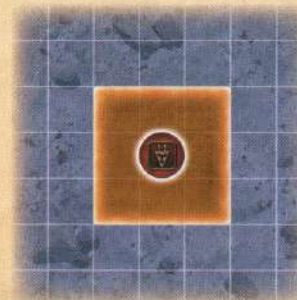
Example: An adventurer begins an encounter with two Potions in their inventory. After taking significant damage, this adventurer could choose to eschew their standard movement to focus, then use their two Potions with their two secondary actions. Even if they had twenty Potions in their inventory, however, they would only be able to use one at the end of a phase.

Placing Markers

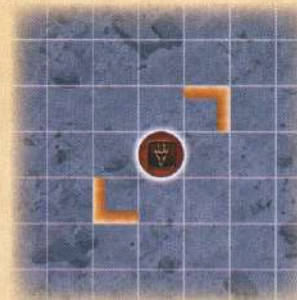
When an ability or effect generates a marker, the GM must place an object or token on the encounter map to represent its marker area. The Starter Set includes two types of markers that can be used in these situations.

As markers are intended to serve as visual cues for what is about to occur on the encounter map, the markers provided come in a variety of colors and patterns to make it easier to differentiate between them.

Tile Markers: These markers are used when an ability or effect generates a marker that covers a specific area of the encounter map, such as 3x3 or 5x5 squares. If a character token is present within the marker area when a marker is generated, remove the token, place the marker, then return the token to the encounter map.



Corner Markers: These markers are used when an ability or effect generates a marker that covers a large swath of the encounter map. For example, you could place two corner markers to represent the two opposite corners of a large square or rectangular marker area.



While the markers included in the Starter Set are sure to come in handy as you play through your chosen scenario, with a little bit of imagination, you can dream up all manner of ways to represent markers in your game. For example, you could keep craft wire or pipe cleaners on hand to encircle the squares in which a marker is generated, or cut clear plastic folders into the appropriate shapes to make your own custom markers.



CHAPTER 4: ADVENTURING

Only a fraction of an adventurer's time is spent locked in combat and other encounters. Rather, their journeys tend to be filled more with information gathering, exploring, traveling, and enjoying the occasional well-deserved rest.

Outside of encounters, adventurers are more likely to come across everyday people than other adventurers or enemies. Interacting with these NPCs can prove either beneficial or detrimental to adventurers, and will often progress the story.

When it's time to interact with NPCs, the GM cooperates with the other players to create interesting, fun, and interactive scenes through **roleplaying**. As the GM, you will describe a situation, the players will announce what their adventurers say or do, and then you will determine the results of those actions. Sometimes a check will be required to decide the outcome of an action, which can propel the story in new and exciting directions.



ROLEPLAYING BASICS

The Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG is a roleplaying game, which means that players will adopt the role of an adventurer. They control all of their characters' actions, while the GM handles overall game progression and story.

Of course, players do not have to be brilliant actors or fully inhabit their characters' personas to play the game. During encounters, for example, their focus will revolve largely around their character's role: tanks draw enemy attacks, healers restore their allies' health, and DPS damage foes. Meanwhile, the GM will decide what actions enemies take and will place markers that indicate incoming attacks.

Outside of encounters, the GM need only explain the current situation as written in the scenario, and then describe how the adventurers' actions affect it. Similarly, players are only required to convey their adventurers' words and deeds, for which even simple descriptions will suffice.

- *My character doesn't like that idea. She's really angry.*
- *My character takes a coffee biscuit out of her bag and gives it to the crying child to calm her down.*

As illustrated above, so long as a player communicates their adventurer's intentions, feelings, and actions to the other members of the group, they should be able to imagine what's going on and respond accordingly.

If you notice a player is struggling to express themselves, you should gently ask them to explain what it is they want to do, and encourage them to talk it over with the group.

While these descriptions don't have to be overly detailed, players are more than welcome to get fully into character by using gestures or unique voices if that's how they like to play.

- *Are you out of your mind!? There's no way I'm going along with that foolhardy plan!* [slams fist on table]
- *Don't worry little girl, it'll all be okay. Oh, I know! Do you like coffee biscuits? I've got a whole bunch, so you can have one if you promise to stop crying.*

Players can also act as if they were their adventurer, conveying their words and actions while in character.

Your group doesn't have to pick one style or the other, either. In roleplaying games, players often enjoy striking their own balance between the two.

Players—including the GM—can roleplay the parts they feel comfortable acting out and explain the rest, or use gestures to convey something that can't be communicated with words alone.

- *My character shouts, "Are you out of your mind!?" and pounds her fist on the table.*
- *My character says, "Would one of these make you feel any better?" and hands the crying girl a coffee biscuit to calm her down.*

When playing the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, each player is free to decide for themselves whether to roleplay like in the examples above, or to create their own unique style of play. So long as everyone understands what's happening and is enjoying the game, the possibilities are endless—so play the way that's fun for you!



MAKING CHECKS OUTSIDE OF ENCOUNTERS

Whether in an encounter, exploring the world, or talking with other characters, the general flow of the game remains the same.

As mentioned in Chapter 1 of the Player Book, the adventure takes the form of a back and forth between the GM and the players. When players choose actions for their adventurers to take, it's up to the GM to explain the outcome. Any undertaking deemed challenging will require a check to determine if it succeeds.

In encounters, adventurers have to act quickly and make good use of their abilities and traits to overcome danger. Ability checks allow them to determine just how effective those maneuvers will be.

However, checks are also used in less stressful situations, such as when interacting with NPCs, collecting items, or even wandering idly. The success of most actions taken is determined by one or more checks that make use of the adventurer's attributes.

If the scenario includes a list of actions the adventurers can take, the GM can either have the players choose an action from that list and proceed as written, or ask them what their adventurers do and determine an appropriate check themselves.

Consider the following situation:

The adventurers track down a boy who has secluded himself in the mountains after losing both of his parents in an accident. This boy is the only one who can give them the information they need, but he isn't particularly willing to talk.

Sympathizing with him to get him to open up requires a **MND** check with a CR of 12. Intimidating him to force him to divulge the information requires a **STR** check with a CR of 18.

There are multiple ways for the GM to convey this to the players.

1. Communicate everything written in the scenario, including the CR.

GM: *You have to get information out of this boy, but he's unwilling to talk. You can make a **MND** check with a CR of 12 to get him to open up, or you can make a **STR** check with a CR of 18 to intimidate him into divulging the information.*

This way, the players can discuss which option they want to pursue with full knowledge of their chances for success. This method is a good fit for GMs who have limited TTRPG experience or struggle with improvisation. Players who are new to roleplaying games may also appreciate having clear direction like this.

2. Only communicate the scenario's suggested actions.

GM: *You have to get information out of this boy, but he's unwilling to talk. You can make a **MND** check to get him to open up, or a **STR** check to intimidate him into divulging the information.*

This way, the players won't know the CR for each check, and can have fun speculating for themselves which option might be easier or bring about the best outcome for their adventurers.

For example, if they know that the boy has secluded himself because of a violent event in his past, they might guess that the **STR** check will be less likely to succeed. Or they could decide that the **MND** check is better because it has the possibility of leading to beneficial outcomes for other NPCs as well.

3. Only communicate the general objective.

GM: *You have to get information out of this boy, but he's unwilling to talk. What do you want to do?*

This way, the players have free rein to try anything they can think of, which will help them become more immersed in the world. The GM can then use the scenario to choose what kind of check would be most appropriate for the players' desired actions.

For example, imagine that the players say, "Well, why don't we try being honest with him? If he knows where we're coming from, maybe he'll open up." The GM can then respond: "Okay, make a **MND** check to see if you succeed in getting through to him."

Alternatively, imagine that the players say, "Let's try roughing him up a little. Maybe that'll get him to cough up the info we need." The GM can then respond: "Okay, make a **STR** check to see if you can intimidate him."

Only communicating the general objective can lead to players making unpredictable suggestions.

A player could say, *"I'm going to logically explain why we need that info, and make sure he can't refuse."* or even, *"My character says, 'Fine, if you don't want to talk, we'll just wait here until you do.' And she plops down on the ground."*

The **MND** or **STR** checks included in the scenario wouldn't be appropriate for these actions, so the GM will need to determine what to do based on the adventurers' profiles and the way the story has progressed so far.

In this case, the GM is free to make their own judgment, regardless of what's written in the scenario. For example, the situations described above could be handled like this:

- ◆ *I'm going to logically explain why we need that info, and make sure he can't refuse.*

A logical explanation would likely require intelligence, and "making sure he can't refuse" would be forcing the information out of him, similar to intimidating him. Thus, an **INT** check with a CR of 18 would be appropriate.

- ◆ *My character says, "Fine, if you don't want to talk, we'll just wait here until you do." And she plops down on the ground.*

A battle of wills requires endurance, equating to **VIT**. As this would be a gentler method of getting the boy to talk, a **VIT** check with a CR of 12 would be appropriate.

MAKING MULTIPLE CHECKS

Sometimes multiple checks will be required to determine whether an action succeeds or fails. When multiple checks are required, it's best to communicate them one at a time in order to avoid confusion.

For example, if the adventurers are searching for a ring at the bottom of a frigid lake, they would need to make a **VIT** check with a CR of 10 to see if they can withstand the cold, and then an **INT** check with a CR of 15 to see if they can find the ring.

In this case, only adventurers who successfully pass the first check may proceed to make the second check, as they can only search for the ring if they're able to endure the icy water.

The following is a good way to convey this to the players: *Make a **VIT** check with a CR of 10 to see if your adventurers can endure the frigid water.*

If some players then fail the check but others succeed, relay those results:

*Those of you who failed hopped out of the lake because it was just too cold to bear. The ones who succeeded manage to brave the chill, and must now make an **INT** check with a CR of 15 to see if they can find the ring at the bottom of the lake.*

AWARDING ADVANTAGE DICE

The GM has the option of giving players one or more advantage dice as a reward for extraordinary achievements. These might include superb roleplaying, having their adventurer take an action that creates an interesting beat in the story, or achieving some unique goal. Advantage dice may be awarded at any time, regardless of what's written in the scenario.

To provide an example of a situation in which advantage dice may be awarded, consider again the boy who secluded himself in the mountains. If the adventurers managed to find and bring him a memento of his parents, then it would be appropriate to award advantage dice for the check to obtain information from him.

Advantage dice may even be awarded for checks that take place during encounters, if the GM and players so desire. Some examples of situations in which advantage dice may be awarded during an encounter include:

- ◆ When someone the adventurers braved great danger to rescue shows up to offer encouraging words during a heated boss encounter.
- ◆ When an enemy the party previously spared comes to the party's aid.
- ◆ When an adventurer boldly risks their life in a selfless attempt to save the day.

In this way, advantage dice can help make climactic moments even more exciting.

There are no set rules for when to award advantage dice. Letting the GM and players decide when they should be given is part of the fun of the game.

GM DISCRETION

The suggestions and examples provided here are just that: suggestions. The GM is free to decide on a style of play that works best for them, and can even change it up depending on the situation.

If the GM has a hard time improvising, they can read out suggested actions from the scenario, as if providing the players with dialogue choices in a Final Fantasy XIV cutscene.

Every playstyle is valid, and remember—the GM always has the final say in any game-related decisions.

THE PASSAGE OF TIME

Naturally, Hydaelyn is not exempt from the march of time, nor are the peoples living upon Her.

On Hydaelyn, one sun consists of 24 elemental hours, just as one day consists of 24 hours for us. Elemental hours are colloquially referred to as “bells” by the people of Eorzea and beyond. Six bells form one cycle, meaning a sun can also be said to be four cycles long.

Usually, there's no need to keep track of how much time passes between when the adventurers accept a quest and when they complete it. However, some quests may be deemed time-sensitive. In these cases, rather than going to the trouble of calculating time down to the minute or second, consider using the following guideline unless the scenario specifies otherwise.

ONE ACTION = ONE BELL

Whenever you need to calculate the passage of time, you may assume that one action takes one bell.

For example, say the adventurers have accepted a delivery quest that takes place in Ul'dah. Assuming no other actions are taken, receiving the items and delivering them would count as two actions, meaning it would take them a total of two bells.

Now, you may think it odd that the simple act of receiving items would take an entire bell. However, this period of time accounts for all of the other little things the party might have to do along the way.

Imagine the adventurers have to receive the items from Cocobuki, eldest of the Thaumaturges' Guild's guildmasters. They would probably want to make themselves presentable first, and practice what they're going to say to ensure they show the proper respect. Then they have to walk to the Arrzaneth Ossuary, where Cocobuki may well ask them to search the premises for their cargo.

The one action = one bell framework also accounts for resting (see page 17), which is essential on long adventures. Between actions, adventurers are wont to do some shopping, enjoy the local cuisine, or stop to smell the oldroses, as it were.

So long as it doesn't become a burden for the GM and other players, you are encouraged to take some time to imagine and describe what's going on while an action is being performed. Painting in these little details can lead to fun twists in the story and make your experience more unique.

ADJUSTING TIME FRAMES

Exceptional cases may occur where the GM deems that a single action takes more than one bell, or where multiple actions can be performed in that same amount of time.

Say an adventurer is looking to purchase five ingredients in a small marketplace so they can cook a culinary creation. Although buying five different items counts as five actions, this shopping spree can be concluded within a bell because of the small scope of the marketplace.

On the other hand, if an adventurer is after a high-quality baguette from a persnickety baker, there's a good chance it will take them more than one bell to complete that single action.

DELEGATING ACTIONS

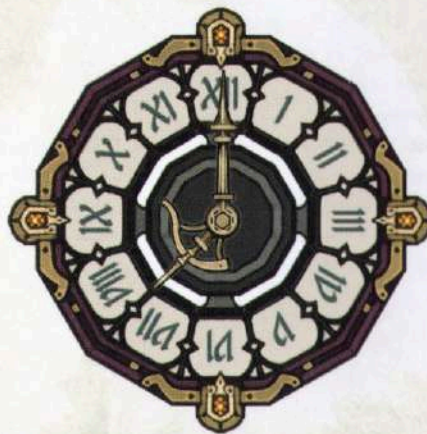
Sometimes, a party of adventurers will decide to divide and conquer, delegating actions to individual party members to accomplish a task more efficiently. When this happens, the players will have to decide which actions each adventurer performs, and in what order. One by one, the GM will determine the results of each adventurer's first action, and by the time they have all taken an action, a bell will have passed.

The GM will also need to make sure the players are aware that if their adventurers happen to be thrust into an encounter while separated from each other, they will have to deal with the situation without the aid of their absent friends.

ENCOUNTERS AND THE PASSAGE OF TIME

Encounters consist of a varying number of phases and rounds, depending on the participants and the situation at hand. Generally speaking, however, encounters are considered to last only one bell, including preparation time and post-encounter recovery.

If all of the adventurers are defeated, the GM may allow the players to try again (see page 62). When this happens, it is up to the GM to determine whether time rewinds to a point before the adventurers were defeated, or to count that time as if it had passed.



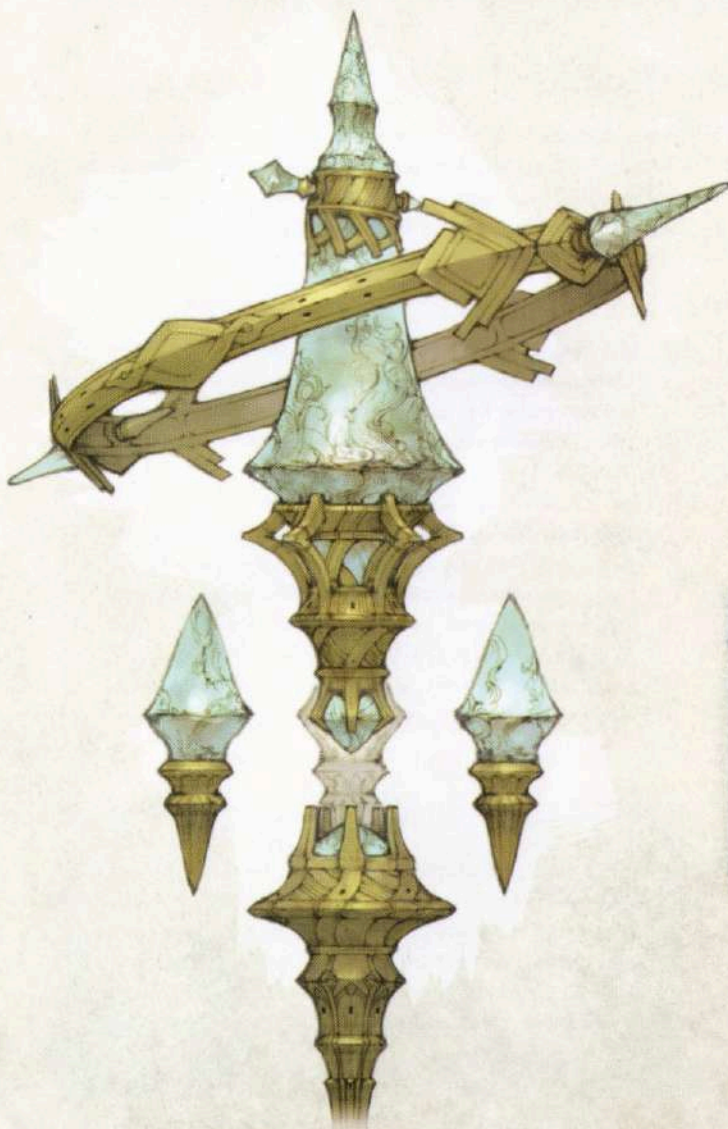
TRAVEL

Adventurers spend a lot of time traveling, whether it's walking around and talking to villagers, journeying to other cities, delving into dungeons, or riding chocobos to find undiscovered lands.

In this game, you generally don't have to concern yourself with travel times. Walking from one end of a small village to the other only takes a few minutes, and even in larger cities, aetherytes make travel a breeze.

Your average adventurer can teleport between major settlements and the assorted locations within them—assuming they've been there and have attuned to the proper aetherytes. As such, adventurers may teleport to any of the aetherytes listed when using Teleport in Final Fantasy XIV, as well as those their profiles or completed scenarios state they have attuned to.

Convenient as it is, teleportation is not always a viable means of transportation. Adventurers cannot teleport to their destination if it lacks an aetheryte, if they need to transport a bulky item, or if they are restricted to a certain mode of travel. In such cases, it is up to the GM to decide how long the journey will take.



REST AND SLEEP

Rest is an essential part of every perilous undertaking. Even veteran adventurers need to sleep sometime, lest they succumb to fatigue.

Adventurers may rest as needed between actions performed in towns and villages, provided they are not on a time-sensitive quest.

REST

If the adventurers wish to rest while on a time-sensitive quest, they may still rest during the time it takes to complete one action, as explained in the one action = one bell section. During this time, they can tend to basic necessities such as eating, drinking, and making simple repairs to their gear.

Traits or items that can only be used while resting cannot be used unless the adventurer is able to rest. The same is true of traits that take effect while resting. In other words, these effects cannot be used during encounters or whenever the GM indicates that an adventurer is unable to rest.

Resting may even be possible inside dungeons, so long as no enemies are nearby and the GM decides to permit it.

SLEEP

Some abilities or traits may have effects that require an adventurer to get a good night's sleep. There may also be times when the GM determines that the party needs to hit the hay.

A minimum of one full cycle—or six bells—must pass for an adventurer to get enough sleep. Adventurers can only sleep if they meet the following requirements:

- ◆ They are somewhere they can breathe comfortably and maintain a normal body temperature.
- ◆ They have a suitable stock of unspoiled food and drink.
- ◆ They do not make any checks or use any abilities.
- ◆ They do not lose any HP or MP.

If their slumber is interrupted in any way, all progress is lost and the groggy adventurer must start over by falling back asleep.

Inns or houses are generally the best places to catch some shut-eye, but experienced adventurers can also find places to sleep out in the wilderness.

If adventurers have gone a full sun—or 24 bells—without sleeping, the GM may decide that they are sleep-deprived and impose a -2 penalty on all checks, even if this is not specified in the scenario. Increase this penalty by 2 for each additional sun they stay awake, making the penalty -4 for two suns without sleep, -6 for three suns, and so on. Sleep deprivation does not count as an enfeeblement and cannot be remedied until the adventurers manage to sleep.

WARNING!

Pages 18 through 61 contain the Starter Set's scenarios. If you intend to participate in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG as an adventurer and not a GM, do **NOT** read these pages, as they contain **massive spoilers** for the story ahead.



SCENARIO 1: THE CRYSTAL CAPER

An Eorzean Scenario, Recommended for a Light Party of Level 30 Adventurers

The average expected playtime for this scenario is three to four hours, or two to three hours for parties of experienced TTRPG players. When following the scenario as intended, the party will take part in three combat encounters.

The GM should review this scenario in full before beginning the game. To avoid spoiling the story, other players should refrain from reading the information contained here in advance.



SCENARIO SYNOPSIS (GM's NOTES)

Momodi approaches the adventurers with a job from Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern. A wagon carrying a shipment of crystals has been attacked, and the Concern needs capable adventurers to track down and retrieve the stolen cargo.

The party's investigation reveals that the crystals were taken by a group of Amalj'aa seeking to summon their deity, Ifrit. They track the thieves to a cave in the Clutch and confront their leader, Flintclaw Graji Gah. After a heated battle, the party emerges victorious and recovers the stolen crystals.

Yet a sinister shadow lurks behind this incident: Galba Iux Pulcher, a soldier of the Garlean Empire. It was he who incited the Amalj'aa to summon Ifrit, informing them of the vast shipment of crystals being transported by Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern. With the eikon's summoning, the completion of the Ultima Weapon project draws ever nearer...

INTRODUCTION

Before starting this scenario, explain to the other players that the story takes place shortly before the Warrior of Light fights Ifrit in Final Fantasy XIV. The adventure begins in Ul'dah, where Momodi, the proprietress of the Quicksand, approaches the party with a job.

Momodi



BEGINNING THE ADVENTURE

Once the players are ready to begin, read the following passage aloud. Feel free to rephrase or adjust the story to better fit the adventurers' backstories or profiles. For convenience's sake, this scenario assumes that the adventurers have already formed a party and are acquainted with each other.

🔊 Your party is relaxing at the Quicksand—home to Ul'dah's Adventurers' Guild—when a red-haired Lalafell strides across the lamplit tavern and approaches your table. You recognize her immediately as the proprietress, Momodi.

Momodi: You lot lookin' for a job, by any chance? As it happens, I've got somethin' that might interest you.

A crystal shipment belongin' to Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern was raided as it was makin' its way to Ul'dah from the Nanawa Mines. The Concern's offerin' good coin to the adventurer who can get to the bottom of this mess and bring back their crystals. What do you say?



At this point, the players might put two and two together and realize that the Amalj'aa have stolen the crystals in an attempt to summon Ifrit. Should this happen, gently remind them that just because they know something doesn't mean their adventurers do as well. The characters have no way of knowing that this incident has anything to do with summoning Ifrit.

If the Party Accepts the Request

The adventurers will receive two Potions and two Ethers from Momodi. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 **Momodi:** *I had a feelin' you'd bite. Here, take these.*

Momodi passes you a pouch containing two Potions and two Ethers.

Momodi: *It's on the house—consider this a little gift to get you started on the right foot.*



Potion

Secondary, Consumable

Target: Self

Base Effect: Restores 3 HP to the target. Discard after use.



Ether

Secondary, Consumable

Target: Self

Base Effect: Restores 1 MP to the target. Discard after use.

Inventory Management

When the party obtains new items, ask the players how they want to divide them among their characters. Any players who take possession of an item should note it down in the inventory section of their adventurer sheets.

Keep in mind that party members may exchange items at any time outside of an encounter, but characters can only use an item if it is in their inventory when an encounter begins. For more information on using items, see page 11.

Momodi explains that the site of the attack falls under the jurisdiction of the Stone Torches, and she directs the party to speak with a Hyuran man named Warin at Black Brush Station.



What to Do If the Party Refuses the Quest

If the players don't express interest in Momodi's job offer, pause the game and explain that this scenario is built around the assumption that the party will accept this task. Encourage them to do so, as the scenario cannot otherwise continue as designed.

Dealing with the Unexpected

During the game, players may surprise you by having their adventurers do something that the scenario doesn't account for. Some examples of this would be asking NPCs for help, splitting the party up to act independently, or trying to go somewhere entirely unrelated to the scenario. If you aren't sure how to adapt to these situations, you can always ask the other players to choose a different action.

That said, you're more than welcome to run with it if you can think of a way to work their ideas into the story. After all, improvising is one of the greatest joys of being a GM!

What Momodi Knows

The adventurers can learn the following by asking Momodi for more information:

- ◆ The missing wagon was transporting crystals from the Nanawa Mines in central Thanalan to Ul'dah.
- ◆ The Stone Torches approached Momodi with the job only a bell or two ago.
- ◆ The Stone Torches assigned to Black Brush Station are investigating the attack; they should be better able to answer the party's questions.

Gathering Information in Ul'dah

The adventurers may attempt to gather more information in Ul'dah, but cannot learn anything beyond the information described above.



- ◆ **Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern:** *Mistress Amajina, the proprietress of a tavern, founded the Concern during the Mad Mythril Rush some century and a half ago. At present, the company controls the main mines in Thanalan, and has grown large and wealthy enough to afford a standing force of sellswords known as the Stone Torches.*
 - ◆ **Black Brush Station:** *A marvel of modern innovation, the steam engine has transformed the mining industry, increasing efficiency and profits thrice over. It has also led to the transformation of what was once a thinly manned aetheryte outpost into a thriving crossroads of labor and commerce—a new pillar to support the thriving Ul'dahn economy.*
 - ◆ **Nanawa Mines:** *Under Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern, Nanawa Mines briefly faced closure when its supplies of quality silver were thought to have been exhausted. With the recent perfection of refining techniques that allow for the extraction of metal from even the lowest quality of ore, however, the mine has once again been opened for excavation.*
 - ◆ **The Stone Torches:** *Established by Fyrgeiss, chairman of Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern, the Stone Torches protect the interests of the company—be that the mining sites themselves, or their freight trains and railway.*
- Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~



BLACK BRUSH STATION

Warin, the Stone Torch in charge of the investigation, is waiting for the party at Black Brush Station.

The adventurers can teleport to the station's aetheryte or make their way there from Ul'dah on foot or atop their mounts. When the party arrives, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ When you arrive at Black Brush Station, a Hyuran man hurries over to greet you. His armor marks him as a member of the Stone Torches.

Stone Torch: *I trust you are the adventurers Momodi sent word of? Well met. My name is Warin, and I am charged with investigating the incident. I would be glad to answer any questions you may have.*

WHAT WARIN KNOWS

The Raid

- ☞ Yesterday evening, a wagon carrying a shipment of crystals was attacked south of the station. The raiders made off with it and its cargo, leaving behind the bodies of the driver and guards.
- ☞ If asked about the guards, Warin explains that the wagon was escorted by four soldiers who, though not as strong as the adventurers, could hold their own in a fight.

- ☞ If asked about the cargo or what was stolen, Warin explains that the wagon was transporting crystals for Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern. While the wagon and its cargo were stolen, the bodies of the driver and guards were found with all of their possessions untouched.

The Thieves and the Site of the Attack

- ☞ If asked about the thieves or the site of the attack, Warin responds: *"It shames me to admit, but the investigation has yet to begin in earnest. We've had our hands full tracking down the victims' next of kin and ensuring the poor souls are given a proper burial. Apologies for the trouble, but could I ask you to go ahead and see what clues there are to be had?"*

Keeping in Contact

- ☞ Warin gives the adventurers a linkpearl and asks them to contact him when they find the stolen crystals so he can dispatch a unit of Stone Torches to recover them.



The adventurers may attempt to gather more information in Black Brush Station, but cannot learn anything beyond what Warin knows.

Additionally, if your group has a copy of the Standard Rulebook, the party can visit Black Brush Station's merchants to purchase items before departing.

THE INVESTIGATION BEGINS

When the party departs for the site of the attack, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ You follow the road south to where the wagon was attacked. Deep red stains mark the arid ground where the victims fell, and the splintered remains of broken crates litter the area. Several guards clad in the armor of the Stone Torches stand watch over the scene.

They notice as you approach, and one comes forward to stop you.

Stone Torch Guard: *Stop right there, adventurers. This place is off-limits, save to those in the employ of Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern.*

If the adventurers explain that Warin sent them, the guards allow the party to investigate the scene. Until they do, the guards will attempt to prevent them from searching the area.

Stone Torch Guards

The guards are there to protect the scene from curious passersby and wandering monsters. They only know as much as Warin does about the raid.

An Untimely Interruption

Before the adventurers have a chance to investigate the scene, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ Before you have so much as a chance to look around, a pack of gigantic ant-like monsters skitter out from behind a nearby outcropping of sun-bleached rocks.

Stone Torch Guard: *That's balls... Where in the seven hells did they come from!? To arms—we can't let them disturb the scene!*

The guards move to engage the antlings, but a pair of the vilekin manages to slip by.

Stone Torch Guard: *Blast, there's too many of them! Give us a hand, adventurers!*

Before you can respond, the two antlings move in to attack you!

After reading the above, prepare for battle!

◆ **Antling:** *Antlings are gigantic vilekin, ubiquitous in Eorzea's desert regions. Despite their lack of higher order intelligence, antling society is rigidly structured, with the queen ensconced at its heart.*
- Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~

Black Brush Station



Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Placement: Antling Sentry x2 (A)

At this point, the players should discuss amongst themselves and determine the order in which their adventurers will take their turns. If they have trouble deciding, suggest they use the following turn order: 1. Tank → 2. Melee DPS → 3. Ranged DPS → 4. Healer



For all encounters in this scenario, allow the players to choose their positions after you have placed the enemies on the encounter map.

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Antling Sentry: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo** (**Trap Jaws** → **Acid Spray**).

- ◆ **Trap Jaws:** Target the nearest adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- ◆ **Acid Spray:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, attack the tank and as many other enemies as possible instead.

If an **Acid Spray** marker is already present on the encounter map, the Antling Sentry attacks using **Trap Jaws** instead of **Combo**.

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will repeat the tactics outlined for round 1.

Antling Sentry



ENCOUNTER DATA

ANTLING SENTRY

Size: Large (2x2) - Vilekin

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 14

Magic Defense: 12

HP: 40

Speed: 6 squares

STR

DEX

VIT

INT

MND

+6

+2

+1

-3

+0

Abilities

Combo

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Trap Jaws**, then immediately use **Acid Spray**.

Trap Jaws

Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 2 squares

Check: STR (d20 + 5) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Acid Spray

Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic

Origin: A square adjacent to this character

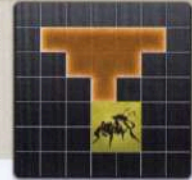
Marker Area: A stationary cone extending up to 2 squares away from the origin (see diagram)

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 4d6 damage to all targets.

This marker can be placed in any square adjacent to the antling, pointing away from it.



Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when all enemies have been reduced to 0 HP. The players are now free to begin their investigation.



Conveying Enemy HP to the Players

There are no HP bars in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, but oftentimes players will want to know how their enemies are faring. When running your first game, you may find it helpful to let your players know when an enemy reaches certain thresholds, such as 50% HP and 10% HP.

How you do this, however, is entirely up to you. For example, when an enemy's HP falls to 50% (20 HP for the antling sentries), you can tell the players this directly, or relay the information in a more evocative manner. Examples of the latter might be "the antling reels from your mighty blow, but quickly regains its footing," or "the antling staggers backward, greenish ichor dripping from countless wounds."

Controlling Enemy Characters

Encounters include an enemy tactics section that outlines the actions enemy characters will take. Resolve each action as described when possible, and adjust their actions using your best judgment when it is not. Additionally, you may move an enemy character on their turn using a standard movement action unless otherwise stated.

Handling Party Defeat

See page 62 for more information on handling party defeat.

INVESTIGATING THE SCENE

The Site of the Attack

The Stone Torches have carried off both the victims' and the chocobos' remains. As reported, the wagon and its load of precious crystals is gone. Everything else has been left untouched.

Examining the Area

If the players want their adventurers to examine the area, have each character make an **INT** check with a CR of 10.

Regardless of success, the adventurers discover a number of clawed, four-toed footprints. This, combined with the scorch marks on the ruined crates, leads them to conclude that the raid was carried out by the Amalj'aa and their drakes. They also find a set of tracks left by the wagon as the raiders pulled it off to the east of Black Brush Station.

A successful check, however, paints a more accurate picture of the raiding party: five Amalj'aa accompanied by a single drake.

If an adventurer gets a 15 or higher on their check, they find evidence suggesting that several other Amalj'aa acted as look-outs while the raid occurred.



◆ **The Amalj'aa:** *The Amalj'aa are a race of nomadic beastmen native to the grasslands of Paglth'an, where they subsist on wandering herds of sheep or small scalekin. Both male and female of the species train in the arts of combat, and any who seek to impede the path of these proud warrior tribes are scourged with fire and steel. For generations the Amalj'aa have made pilgrimage to their holy lands in Thanalan, a practice which often brings them into contact—and conflict—with the inhabitants of Ul'dah.*

◆ **Drake:** *Drakes are vicious and unrelenting hunters, often tracking prey over several malms before roasting their exhausted quarry with a torrid breath. The Amalj'aa are known to domesticate drakes for use as mounts and hunting companions, amongst other things.*
- Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~

Further Information Gathering

If the players wish to gather more information in the surrounding area, tell them that a tavern called the **Coffer & Coffin** can be found nearby, and that they might find more clues there.

While none of the tavern's patrons witnessed the attack, the party can ask around and learn the following information without making any checks. You may simply read these passages aloud, or encourage the players to engage in a bit of roleplay with the NPCs in the tavern.

☞ **Chatty Customer:** *Aye, I was nursin' a pint here yesterday. Was gettin' nice and comfy, too, when all at once there comes a roar from off to the east. Sobered me up right quick. Must've been monsters or some such, I wager.*

Ye wanna know when I heard it? Let me think... I'd just ordered a bite to eat, so it must've been around sundown.

☞ **Wowobaru:** *Yesterday eve? A murky mist made marking matters outside the alehouse all but futile!*

☞ **Ebrious Elder:** *Urp... Hic! I saws it, I did! Great shadowy figures, marchin' straight into the river! ...Zzz...*

If the adventurers try to rouse the Ebrious Elder and ask for more details, he will wake and say: "Urgh, my head... Hrm? Yesterday? Couldn't tell ya. S'all a blur..."

He cannot provide any further information, even with a successful check.



◆ **The Coffer & Coffin:** *A favorite haunt for the area's many miners, the Coffer & Coffin has ale to wet the throats and stew to fill the bellies of any and all who have the wherewithal to pay for the tavern's simple luxuries.*
- Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~

The Coffer & Coffin



WAGON TRACKS

The adventurers can follow the wagon tracks they discovered at the site of the attack without making any checks. If the party decides to take this course of action, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ You take your leave of the Stone Torches and follow the tracks away from the site of the attack. They lead you past the station and to the east, and end at a bridge separating Black Brush and the Clutch.

Below the bridge passes the merest trickle of a river known as Soot Creek. It flows from a cave to the north and passes through another cave due south.

The tracks appear to avoid the bridge entirely, instead vanishing into the river's waters.

Traversing Soot Creek

The river is shallow and its current is gentle, so it doesn't impede the adventurers in any way. Assure the party that they won't suffer any penalties for stepping into the water.



The Two Caves

If the players ask you about the caves, explain that the one upstream leads to a settlement known as Lost Hope, while the one downstream passes through the mountain and comes out just short of Fesca's Wash. If the raiders moved the stolen wagon past either of these places, someone would have noticed; the lack of any such news suggests the thieves steered clear of both locations.

◆ **Lost Hope:** *As the name implies, none but those who have lost all hope dare enter this forsaken place.*

◆ **Fesca's Wash:** *Built in the shadow of a towering monolith known as Fesca's Watch, adventurers created the near-eponymous camp outside the city walls to escape the exorbitant price of a room within Ul'dah.*

- Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~

Searching for Tracks

If the adventurers attempt to track the wagon or the Amalj'aa through the river, have each character make a **MND** check with a CR of 12. Characters who succeed quickly notice a trail of displaced rocks along the riverbed. It appears that someone or something entered the river and headed downstream.

Even if the entire party fails the check, they still manage to discover this trail, although it takes them half a bell to do so. This delay means they will not make it to the southern cave in time to witness the hooded man meeting with the Amalj'aa.

Examining the Bridge

On the other side of the bridge is a road that leads to eastern Thanalan. If the adventurers examine the bridge, they can determine without making a check that it bears no tracks left by the stolen wagon.

If the adventurers opt to cross the bridge and search for clues along the road to eastern Thanalan, they find nothing of relevance. The party will need to return to Soot Creek and investigate further to proceed.

SOUTHERN CAVE - ENTRANCE

If the party succeeded on the check to find the trail in the river and followed it without delay, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ You follow the trail of displaced rocks downstream, but pause when the cave entrance comes into view. Before it stands a man dressed in the garb of a merchant, conversing with an Amalj'aa warrior. A hood hides the man's face from view, and you're too far away to overhear what is being said. A few moments pass, after which the two part ways. The man walks off to the east, while the Amalj'aa disappears into the cave's dark maw.

Following the Man

If the adventurers decide to follow the man, they discover that his footprints vanish abruptly behind a craggy bluff. If they succeed in making a **MND** check with a CR of 20, they notice that the rocks in the area appear to be marred by gashes left by some kind of machine, but are unable to pick up the mysterious man's trail.

Entering the Cave

If the party failed the check to find the trail in the river, nobody is in front of the cave when they arrive.

Regardless of what the party did beforehand, they are ambushed by the Amalj'aa upon entering the cave. Adventurers with a **Vigilance** of 11 or higher notice the Amalj'aa just before they strike, while all others begin the encounter surprised.



The entrance to the cave lacks suitable cover and is well-lit by sunlight. As such, there is no way for the adventurers to sneak into the cave or otherwise take the Amalj'aa ambushers by surprise.



When the party enters the cave, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 The river remains shallow inside the cave, and the only sound you hear as you make your way inside is the faint splash-splash of water.

Suddenly, six Amalj'aa jump out at you from the dark! Four of them wield pairs of hora, while two wield staves.

Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Amalj'aa Bruiser x4 (B)
2. Amalj'aa Seer x2 (S)

The river doesn't impede the characters' movement or impose penalties on their actions.

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Amalj'aa Bruiser: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Devastate**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Amalj'aa Seer: Attack the most distant adventurer using **Fire**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will repeat the tactics outlined for round 1.



ENCOUNTER DATA

AMALJ'AA BRUISER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 14

Magic Defense: 12

Max HP: 40

Speed: 5 squares

STR

DEX

VIT

INT

MND

+4

+2

+1

+0

+0

Abilities

Devastate

Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 4 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 1d6 damage.

Amalj'aa Bruiser

AMALJ'AA SEER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 12

Magic Defense: 14

Max HP: 30

Speed: 5 squares

STR

DEX

VIT

INT

MND

+1

+1

+1

+4

+1

Abilities

🔥 Fire

Primary, Magic, Fire-Aspected, Invoked

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Check: INT (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Magic Defense

Base Effect: Deals 4 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 1d6 damage.

Amalj'aa Seer

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when all enemies have been reduced to 0 HP. When this occurs, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 The river continues on into the shadowy depths of the cave. Now that you've dealt with the Amalj'aa, nothing is stopping you from exploring the area.



The Amalj'aa are a proud race. Even if the adventurers capture them, they remain silent and refuse to answer any of the party's questions.

SOUTHERN CAVE - EFT CORPSES

When the party ventures deeper into the cave after defeating the Amalj'aa lookouts, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 You follow the river deeper into the cave, but soon stumble across a gruesome scene: the corpses of a half-dozen efts block the way ahead. It appears someone left their bodies to rot in the muggy gloom.

The eft corpses are situated in a way that makes it difficult for the adventurers to get by them without splashing about in the river.

Have each character make a **DEX** check with a CR of 5 to see if they can maneuver around the corpses silently.

If the entire party succeeds on the check, they manage to bypass the corpses without a sound. Unaware that the adventurers are coming, Grajj Gah won't be able to use **Flaming Spear** at the beginning of the upcoming encounter.

Any adventurer who fails the check stumbles over the tail of a dead eft and falls into the river with an echoing splash. While this alerts Grajj Gah to their presence, it also provides the adventurer with a closer look at the eft's wounds. The blackened patches of hide suggest that the Amalj'aa's drakes are capable of breathing fire over a wide area.

Even if the party succeeds on the **DEX** check, they can still glean this information if they choose to investigate the corpses and succeed on an **INT** check with a CR of 10.



The Eft Corpses

The efts were killed by the Amalj'aa, who worried that the splashing of the wavekin would make noise and draw unwanted attention. You don't need to reveal this to the players.

◆ **Eft:** A large wavekin that dwells in Thanalan's rivers.

SOUTHERN CAVE - CRYSTAL TROVE

The stolen wagon of crystals is located midway between the cave's two entrances, and is guarded by a large drake and an Amalj'aa warrior—Flintclaw Grajj Gah. When the adventurers approach the wagon, read the following cutscene aloud for the other players.

Note that in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, player characters are unable to take action or otherwise intervene during cutscenes.



Eft

Cutscene

▶ The cave widens as you reach the midway point between its two entrances. There you find the stolen wagon, still laden with gleaming crystals, hidden just out of sight against the far wall.

Before you can react, a giant reptilian drake emerges from the shadows, standing protectively between you and the stolen crystals. An Amalj'aa warrior steps out from behind it, a vicious-looking spear held ready in his clawed hands.

Amalj'aa: So, you come for the crystals—our crystals. They are to be an offering to the mighty Ifrit, Lord of the Inferno. We will not suffer unbelievers to interfere.

A hunter has no mercy for its prey, and you should expect none from me. And now, you have nowhere left to run!

The Amalj'aa warrior motions with his left hand and the drake lets out an earsplitting roar. Suddenly, four Amalj'aa come running from the direction of the cave's southern exit and quickly encircle your position.

Grajj Gah: I am Flintclaw Grajj Gah, and it is by my hand that you will learn the folly of opposing the will of Lord Ifrit!

Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Flintclaw Grajj Gah (G) x1
2. Worker Drake (D) x1
3. Amalj'aa Bruiser (B) x2
4. Amalj'aa Seer (S) x2

At this point in the scenario, the adventurers can use their limit breaks. Make sure to inform the players of this before initiating the encounter.

The river doesn't impede the characters' movement or impose penalties on their actions.



If an Adventurer Failed to Bypass the Eft Corpses

If even a single adventurer failed the **DEX** check when moving past the eft corpses earlier, Grajj Gah ambushes the party when they discover the crystals. He uses **Flaming Spear** to generate a marker at the start of the encounter, before the [Adventurer Step] begins.

If the entire party succeeded on their **DEX** checks, this ambush doesn't occur.

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Grajj Gah: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (True Thrust → Flaming Spear)**.

- ◆ **True Thrust:** Target the nearest adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- ◆ **Flaming Spear:** Place the marker to attack the tank, regardless of whether they have **Enmity** on this character.

Worker Drake: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Bite → Burning Cyclone)**.

- ◆ **Bite:** Target the nearest adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- ◆ **Burning Cyclone:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible, regardless of whether a tank has **Enmity** on this character.

Amalj'aa Bruiser: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Devastate**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Amalj'aa Seer: Attack the most distant adventurer using **Fire**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will repeat the tactics outlined for round 1.



Flintclaw Grajj Gah



Worker Drake

ENCOUNTER DATA

FLINTCLAW GRAJJ GAH

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 15

Defense: 15 Magic Defense: 15
 Max HP: 60 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +6 +2 +2 +1 +5

Traits

Elite Foe: Amalj'aa Pride

This character cannot be **Stunned**, and markers they have generated cannot be removed. Be sure to inform the players of this before beginning the encounter.

Abilities

Combo

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **True Thrust**, then immediately use **Flaming Spear**.

True Thrust

Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 6) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 6 damage and inflicts a DOT (3) on the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Flaming Spear

Primary, Mobile Marker, Magic, Fire-Aspected

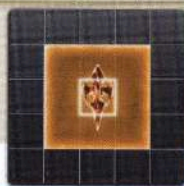
Origin: 1 enemy

Marker Area: A mobile 3x3 area centered on the origin that moves with the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 3d6 damage to all targets.



WORKER DRAKE

Size: Large (2x2) - Scalekin

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 14 Magic Defense: 13
 Max HP: 70 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +5 +1 +2 -2 +0

Abilities

Combo

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Bite**, perform an optional standard movement action, then immediately use **Burning Cyclone**.

Bite

Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 2 squares

Check: STR (d20 + 5) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 6 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

INVK Burning Cyclone

Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic, Fire-Aspected, Invoked

Origin: A square adjacent to this character

Marker Area: A stationary cone extending up to 3 squares away from the origin (see diagram)

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 4d6 damage to all targets.



AMALJ'AA BRUISER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 14 Magic Defense: 12
 Max HP: 40 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +4 +2 +1 +0 +0

Abilities

Devastate

Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 4 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 1d6 damage.

AMALJ'AA SEER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 12 Magic Defense: 14
 Max HP: 30 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +1 +1 +1 +4 +1

Abilities

INVK Fire

Primary, Magic, Fire-Aspected, Invoked

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Check: INT (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Magic Defense

Base Effect: Deals 4 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 1d6 damage.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when Grajj Gah and the worker drake have been reduced to 0 HP. Any Amalj'aa bruisers or seers left standing lose the will to fight and flee.

After the encounter, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 **Grajj Gah:** *Lord Ifrit... I have failed you...*

Grajj Gah collapses amidst the dying embers of the drake's fire, and a sheet of parchment slips free from a pouch at his waist. You pick it up and are surprised to find it contains detailed information on the transportation schedules of Amajina & Sons' crystal shipments. A signature at the bottom reads "Galba lux Pulcher."

You contact Warin via linkpearl to let him know that you've found the stolen crystals, and he answers without delay.

Warin: *Well done! I will mobilize the Stone Torches at once. Would you keep an eye on the place until we arrive? We don't know when the Amalj'aa might return. Once we retrieve the crystals, you can consider your job finished.*



If the players forget to contact Warin or try to have their adventurers take the crystals for themselves, remind them that this is an official job they accepted through the Adventurers' Guild.

EYES OF SCORN

Not long after the party contacts Warin, a unit of Stone Torches arrives at the cave. Read the following cutscene aloud for the other players:

Cutscene

🔊 You stand watch over the crystals until Warin arrives with a unit of Stone Torches, then help them wheel the stolen wagon out of the cave.

Unbeknownst to you, a man in merchant garb watches from a nearby clifftop as your party labors with the precious cargo. A passing breeze blows back his hood, revealing a pearl-like orb set into his forehead. This third eye marks him a man of Garlemald.

Garlean: *This is what I get for relying on beasts. I had hoped they would put up more of a fight...but no matter. Their ilk already possesses the crystals they need to summon Ifrit.*

Still, I cannot allow those Eorzean barbarians to interfere with our plans again. Mark my words, savages, you will rue the day you crossed Galba lux Pulcher!

The man scowls, turns his back on the scene far below, and departs into the dusty distance.

EPILOGUE

A few suns later, the adventurers return to the Quicksand, where Momodi introduces them to a Lalafellin adventurer named Cellica Flame.

This new acquaintance informs them that the Amalj'aa managed to abscond with some of the stolen crystals, which they used to summon Ifrit. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 A few suns after recovering the crystals, Momodi summons you to the Quicksand. She meets you at the door, accompanied by an unfamiliar Lalafellin adventurer.

Momodi: *Thanks for stoppin' by! This lass has been dyin' to meet you. Says she's got news about those crystals you recovered, too.*

She gestures to the Lalafellin adventurer, who drops a curtsy as she introduces herself.

Cellica Flame: *So you are the brave souls who managed to retrieve the crystals from the Amalj'aa. My name is Cellica Flame. It is a pleasure to make your acquaintance.*

I know not if the news has reached you, but a group of Amalj'aa succeeded in summoning the primal Ifrit not long ago by using a sizable supply of crystals—crystals which were later discovered to have been stolen from Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern. It is this that led me to you.

Were it not for you and your recovery of the crystals, Ifrit may well have become far more formidable than he already was. In that sense, you could say you had a hand in the primal's defeat, albeit indirectly. I cannot thank you enough for your aid.

Yet I must admit, I fear something sinister is afoot here. If I am correct, I do not doubt we will be seeing each other again before long. I confess, it is heartening to know I have such capable allies upon whom I can rely. Until we meet again, farewell, my brave adventurers!

With that, Cellica sketches another curtsy and strides away, quickly disappearing into the crowded streets of Ul'dah.

This cutscene marks the end of the scenario. The party members each earn the title "Cellica's Brave Adventurer" for completing this scenario, and should write this down in their adventurer profiles. See page 22 of the Player Book for more information on titles.

THE ADVENTURE CONTINUES

The adventure continues with Scenario 2: Imperial Machinations, in which the adventurers receive a summons from Flame General Raubahn and embark on another quest.

Scenario 2 is intended for a party of four level 40 adventurers. You may assume that any characters who participated in this scenario have completed several other quests before Scenario 2 begins, allowing them to reach the required level.

TO BE CONTINUED...



SCENARIO 2: IMPERIAL MACHINATIONS

An Eorzean Scenario, Recommended for a Light Party of Level 40 Adventurers

The average expected playtime for this scenario is three to four hours, or two to three hours for parties of experienced TTRPG players. When following the scenario as intended, the party will take part in three combat encounters.

This scenario is intended as a continuation of Scenario 1: The Crystal Caper, and it is recommended that the same players and adventurers set off on this particular journey. If you plan to play this scenario as a standalone story or with different players or adventurers, feel free to rephrase or adjust the story to better fit the situation.

The GM should review this scenario in full before beginning the game. To avoid spoiling the story, other players should refrain from reading the information contained here in advance.



SCENARIO SYNOPSIS (GM's NOTES)

Raubahn summons the adventurers to the Hall of Flames, where he entrusts them with an important mission: his scouts have reported suspicious movements from the Garlean Empire's forces in northern Thanalan, and he wants the party to investigate what those devious imperials are up to.

After accepting this task, the party makes their way to Camp Bluefog. There, they speak with members of the Immortal Flames garrison and learn that monsters in the area have been unusually aggressive of late. The source of this agitation is soon revealed to be the discordant and frightening sounds of an ongoing imperial experiment.

The XIVth Imperial Legion has been secretly testing a new and deadly weapon in Raubahn's Push for the past three days, and overseen by an imperial officer named Galba lux Pulcher, its development is almost at an end. The party confronts Galba, who selects these irritating interlopers as the final test subjects for his nearly completed weapon of war.

INTRODUCTION

Before starting this scenario, explain to the other players that the story is set during the period in which Legatus Gaius van Baelsar is working to complete the Ultima Weapon.

The adventure begins in Ul'dah, where the party receives an urgent summons to the Hall of Flames.

A QUICK VISIT TO THE QUICKSAND

Once the players are ready to begin, read the following passage aloud. Feel free to rephrase or adjust the story to better fit the adventurers' backstories or profiles. For convenience's sake, this scenario assumes that the adventurers have already formed a party and are acquainted with each other.



- ◆ **The Immortal Flames:** Ul'dah's Grand Company is a military organization formed by the city-state in an effort to restructure its armed forces. Named after an elite force from Ul'dah's distant and glorious past, its current iteration serves to protect Ul'dah's interests and train promising new recruits.
- ◆ **The Hall of Flames:** *The Hall of Flames serves as headquarters to the city-state's Grand Company—the Immortal Flames. It was built over old Topaz Lane in an effort to restore an unused part of the city that had, until recently, become overrun with unsavory types.*
- Entries in italics from *Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~*

🔊 Footsore and thirsty, you step into the common room of the Quicksand—Ul'dah's premier tavern and local branch of the Adventurers' Guild. The place bustles with activity, and adventurers laugh, shout, and sing in every nook and alcove. A puffed-up Lalafell stands atop a central table reciting a tale of their heroism and bravery, while a few tables over a group of tipsy Miqu'te engage in a lively game of cards.

While you stand surveying the scene, Momodi, proprietress of the Quicksand, strides up to greet you.

Momodi: *Well well, I see we've some local celebrities in our midst. Your lot are on everyone's lips of late, and tales of your exploits have been makin' the rounds. I'd say you look like you could use a drink and a good night's rest, but I don't doubt you'll have a new job knockin' at your door before the mornin' bell.*

...Speakin' of jobs, looks like one just waltzed in through my front door.

You follow Momodi's gaze and see a man in an Immortal Flames uniform stepping through the tavern's entrance. He scans the room, and after spotting you, quickly hurries over.

Flame Commander Swift: *Pardon me for interrupting. My name is Swift, Flame Commander. I come on behalf of a potential employer who is most eager to meet you. Would you mind accompanying me to the Hall of Flames?*

If the adventurers ask Swift for details on the job, he will simply respond that they will learn everything they wish to know at the Hall of Flames. If they press him, he'll say that he is sworn to secrecy and can reveal no further information.

RAUBAHN'S REQUEST

A soldier greets the party when they arrive at the Hall of Flames and leads them into an inner chamber, where Raubahn is waiting for them. After a short conversation, he tasks the party with an important mission. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

Flame Commander Swift leads you to the Hall of Flames, where a young soldier has been posted to await your arrival. After a perfunctory greeting, he swiftly ushers you into a well-appointed meeting room, where a heavily muscled giant of a man appears to have been waiting for you.

Raubahn: *I thank you for meeting with me on such short notice. I am Raubahn Aldynn, Flame General. Word of your considerable exploits has reached me, and thus I have a task I would entrust to you.*

My scouts report suspicious activity behind imperial lines in northern Thanalan, and I would like you to investigate the matter. Ascertain to what ends they plot, then report back to me with your findings.

This task would normally fall to our forces at Camp Bluefog, but recent troubles have left them with their hands tied. May I count on your assistance?

If the adventurers accept this quest, Raubahn presents them with a bottle of Company-Issue Tonic with the words "You may find this useful." He then recommends they begin by speaking to the garrison at Camp Bluefog to learn more about the situation.



Company-Issue Tonic

Primary, Consumable

Target: 1 **Knocked Out** character

Base Effect: Removes the **Knocked Out** enfeeblement from a single character within 5 squares of the user, then restores 1d6 + 3 HP, grants **Transcendent**, and afflicts them with **Weakness**. This item can also target a character outside the encounter map. When doing so, move the character to an empty square within 5 squares of the user after resolving the item's effects.

Inventory Management

When the party obtains new items, ask the players how they want to divide them among their characters. Any players who take possession of an item should note it down in the inventory section of their adventurer sheets.

Keep in mind that party members may exchange items at any time outside of an encounter, but characters can only use an item if it is in their inventory when an encounter begins.

Remind the party that if an encounter has multiple phases, each adventurer can use a single item when a phase ends. For more information on using items, see page 11.



What to Do If the Party Refuses the Quest

If the adventurers decline Raubahn's request, pause the game and explain that this scenario is built around the assumption that the party will accept this task. Encourage them to do so, as the scenario cannot otherwise continue as designed.





◆ **Raubahn Aldynn:** Known as the Bull of Ala Mhigo, Raubahn Aldynn is a 44-year-old Highlander Hyur who attained fame and fortune as a champion gladiator of the bloodsands. Now, he leads the Immortal Flames as its Flame General, and is heavily involved in Ul'dah's politics as a member of the Syndicate.

◆ **Camp Bluefog:** *Camp Bluefog was built as a post whence armed men could patrol the Ceruleum Field. Originally, this duty fell to the Brass Blades and Stone Torches. With the Empire's forces a mere stone's throw away, however, the Immortal Flames have since taken control.*

◆ **Ceruleum Processing Plant:** *Operated by Amajina & Sons Mineral Concern, this plant refines raw ceruleum into a fuel for engines and other modern machinery. The Immortal Flames keep a heavy contingent of soldiers on hand to ensure that the facility and its precious product do not fall into enemy hands.*

- Entries in italics from *Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~*

CAMP BLUEFOG

The party, if they so choose, can teleport directly from Ul'dah to Camp Bluefog. However the party gets there, they arrive to find that the outpost is abuzz with activity. Garrison troops are preparing for a sortie to battle a horde of rampaging monsters as a soldier—Flame Sergeant Cracked Fist—shouts out orders.

When the adventurers arrive, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 When you arrive at Camp Bluefog, you find the outpost a hive of activity. Couriers rush hither and thither carrying messages and supplies, and grim-looking soldiers sharpen weapons and buckle on armor. A uniformed Roegadyn man stands surveying the chaos and barking orders, his voice straining to be heard over the din.

Flame Soldier: *Make haste! We must reinforce our comrades at once, lest Camp Bluefog be overrun!*

...You there, adventurers. Your timing could not be more fortuitous. We find ourselves beset on all sides by swarms of slaving monsters, and skilled fighters such as yourselves are in precious short supply. If you have the time to spare, your assistance would be greatly appreciated.

It appears that the garrison is preparing for battle, and from the sound of it, they could use a hand exterminating the ferocious monsters threatening the camp.



What to Do If the Party Refuses the Quest

If the party refuses to aid the soldier, a pack of three basilisks breaks through the garrison's defensive line and makes it into Camp Bluefog proper. These basilisks set their stony sights on the adventurers and attack with merciless speed. This combat encounter is identical to the one found in the section below.

THE RAMPAGING SCALEKIN

The party joins with troops from Camp Bluefog and sets out to face the monster swarm. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

🔊 You hurriedly depart Camp Bluefog to join the embattled defenders. It's not long before you spot a knot of soldiers locked in fierce combat with a horde of wild-eyed monsters. Though the garrison's troops are resisting bravely, you can see that they are heavily outnumbered, and many already sport vicious wounds.

Flame Soldier: *Seven hells, they're breaking through! Someone stop them before they get inside the walls!*

As the soldier shouts, you see three basilisks smash their way through your allies' lines. The scalekin break into a madcap scuffle, and you realize you're the only things standing between them and Camp Bluefog.

If the Party Refused the Quest

If the party refused to aid the garrison and stayed in Camp Bluefog, read the following aloud instead of the passage above:

🔊 You refuse the soldier's request and remain in Camp Bluefog. After a few minutes, you hear the sounds of battle coming from the north intensify, and shouts and screams echo through the air. Then, with a bound and a hiss, three basilisks crash through the gates and into the camp proper! They crane their necks in search of prey, and fix their sights on you. Prepare for battle!



◆ **Basilisk:** *The basilisk is a large scalekin common to most regions of Aldenard. As is the case with many others in the scalekin family, basilisks are swift to respond to any perceived intrusion of their territory with unrestrained ferocity.*

- *Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~*

Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Placement: Basilisk x3 (B)

The Immortal Flames troops are busy engaging other enemies and will not participate in this combat encounter.

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Basilisk: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Gnaw → Body Slam)**.

- ◆ **Gnaw:** Target the nearest adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- ◆ **Body Slam:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, attack the tank and as many other enemies as possible instead. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

Round 2

Basilisk: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Gnaw → Stone Gaze)**.

- ◆ **Gnaw:** Target the nearest adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- ◆ **Stone Gaze:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible, regardless of whether a tank has **Enmity** on this character. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will alternate between the tactics outlined for rounds 1 and 2.

ENCOUNTER DATA

BASILISK

Size: Large (2x2) - Scalekin

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 13		Magic Defense: 11		
Max HP: 60		Speed: 8 squares		
STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+6	+2	+2	-2	+1

Abilities

Combo Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Gnaw**, perform an optional standard movement action, then immediately use either **Body Slam** or **Stone Gaze**.

Gnaw Primary, Physical

Target: Single **Range:** 1 square

Check: STR - 1 (d20 + 5) **CR:** Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 6 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Body Slam Primary, Stationary Marker, Physical

Origin: A square occupied by this character

Marker Area: A stationary 3x3 area centered on the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 5d6 damage to all targets.



Stone Gaze Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic, Invoked

Marker Area: A stationary 3x3 area adjacent to this character

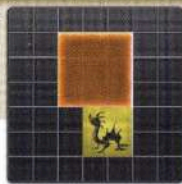
Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: All targets must make a **DEX** check with a CR of 10. Any character who fails this check is afflicted with the **Petrify** enfeeblement, which has the following effects:

- A **Petrified** character cannot act during their turn or use **instant** abilities.
- Characters receive one advantage die when making ability checks targeting a **Petrified** character.
- A **Petrified** character incurs a -5 penalty on all checks.
- **Petrify** is removed at the end of the **Petrified** character's next turn.

This marker can be placed in any square adjacent to the basilisk.



Basilisk



For all encounters in this scenario, allow the players to choose their positions after you have placed the enemies on the encounter map.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when two of the three basilisks have been reduced to 0 HP. The remaining basilisk flees the field, and the flame soldier who first greeted the adventurers asks the party to accompany him back to camp so they can be briefed on the situation.

Read the following passage aloud for the other players, adjusting accordingly if they refused to accept the request for aid against the scalekin:

Flame Soldier: We set those thrice-accursed scalekin to flight, but we could not have done it without your timely aid. We owe you adventurers our gratitude.

The truth is that we have been hard-pressed these past few days. Something has unnerved the local beasts, causing them to turn fang and claw on anything that moves. We are stretched thin, yet our calls for reinforcements have gone unanswered...

Here, the soldier pauses and surveys the bloody battlefield.

But this is no place for long-winded tales. I suggest we return to Camp Bluefog. We can speak more there.



Camp Bluefog

THE LAY OF THE LAND

Once the battle with the basilisks is over and the party has returned to Camp Bluefog, Cracked Fist—the flame sergeant in charge of the local garrison—explains the situation to the party. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

With the basilisks defeated, the garrison's soldiers welcome you into their barracks. They offer you seats around a heavy wooden table, and pile food and ale atop it for you to tuck into.

As you're eating your fill, the hulking Roegadyn you spoke with earlier lowers himself onto an undersized stool at the head of the table.

Cracked Fist: *Flame Sergeant Cracked Fist, at your service. I command the garrison here at Camp Bluefog.*

Your performance in the battle proves that you adventurers are worth your salt. This being the case, I would ask a favor of you.

Over the past few days, the monsters in the area have become unpredictable and violent—more so than usual, at any rate. My soldiers are doing all they can to stem the tide, but truth be told, we are hanging on by our fingernails, and barely at that.

I need someone to figure out what is riling the beasts, and I can think of no one more capable than yourselves. We have an inkling of where you can begin your search, too: the Ceruleum Processing Plant north of here. Would you do us the kindness of looking into this matter to see what you can find?

If the party accepts Cracked Fist's request, they can gather additional information from the NPCs listed here.

You can handle this investigation in one of two ways:

1. Suggest that the players gather information before leaving Camp Bluefog. You can inform them that there are two NPCs with quest icons over their heads nearby, or even share a list of the NPCs the party can speak to.

2. Ask the players what they would like to do next. If the players want to explore Camp Bluefog or speak with any locals, you can introduce the NPCs listed below organically as the story unfolds.

Though the players are able to travel freely between the Ceruleum Processing Plant and Camp Bluefog via teleportation or mundane means, it is generally best to imply that the party should gather information in Camp Bluefog first before traveling to the Ceruleum Processing Plant and gathering any additional information they require there.

GATHERING INFORMATION IN CAMP BLUEFOG

Flame Private Second Class Adelena (Hyuran Woman)

If the party approaches Adelena, she responds:

Adelena: *Excuse me, but I'm rather busy at the moment. Part of the northern barricade was badly damaged during that last attack. It's my job to repair it, so I don't have any time to chat.*

If the party offers to help Adelena repair the barricade, have each character make a **STR** check with a CR of 15. Regardless of success, Adelena eventually finishes repairing the barricade and thanks the adventurers for their help.

Adelena: *Phew! That got done in a twinkling, thanks to you. ...Investigating the monster attacks, are you? Truth is, I don't know much, but I can tell you that it was only about three days ago that this whole mess got started. Until then, the monsters were out there doing... I don't know, whatever it is the godsdamned beasts normally do.*

If any of the adventurers succeed on their **STR** checks, Adelena gives the party a Potion as thanks for their skilled help.



Potion

Secondary, Consumable

Target: Self

Base Effect: Restores 3 HP to the target. Discard after use.

Papawazu (Lalafellin Man)

When the party approaches Papawazu, they overhear him muttering to himself.

Papawazu: *This is a catastrophe! A catastrophe! Those murderous monsters made a mess of my merchandise! It's scattered everywhere, and I simply do not have the time to find it all myself. Fah! A nine-time Employee of the Moon at Amajina & Sons—which would be me, yes, thank you!—should not have to suffer such slings and sorrows and outrageous misfortune!*

If the party chooses to help Papawazu search for his lost merchandise, have each character make a **MND** check with a CR of 12. Regardless of success, Papawazu eventually collects all his goods and thanks the party with his characteristic aplomb.

Papawazu: *Fine job, yes, very fine job. At least someone around here has their priorities straight. Hmph! I wish I could leave this wretched place—and slam the door behind me for good measure!—but important work keeps me. I'm at my wit's end, I'll have you know! Eerie sounds from the north have been keeping me awake for days now, and I am nothing without my beauty sleep. Oh, I do hope I'm recalled to Ul'dah and given a nice cushy job with a nice cushy chair... The Twelve know I deserve it.*

...Hm? What eerie sounds? The eerie sounds! Honestly, are your ears stuffed with chocobo down!? Stop bothering me and head to the Ceruleum Processing Plant. You can't miss those vexatious sounds there.

If any of the adventurers succeed on their **MND** checks, Papawazu gives the party a vial of Ether as payment for their assistance.

**Ether**

Secondary, Consumable

Target: Self

Base Effect: Restores 1 MP to the target. Discard after use.

GATHERING INFORMATION AT THE CERULEUM PROCESSING PLANT

Inebriated Amajina & Sons Miner (Hyuran Man)

Miner: *Eh? Got questions, do you? Well, I got answers, but you gotta best me an' me friends in a drinkin' contest to get 'em! So, what'll it be?*

The crowd of miners presses in around you, and begins cheering, shouting, and acting as only boisterous, extremely inebriated miners can.

Miner: *Yeah! Drink 'em under the table!*

Another Miner: *Show those adventurers how a real miner holds his liquor!*

Any adventurers who choose to join in the drinking contest must make a **VIT** check. Refer below to determine the outcome:

15 or higher: The adventurer remains sober

8 - 14: The adventurer becomes somewhat tipsy

7 or lower: The adventurer becomes stone drunk

Ceruleum Processing Plant



If the Adventurer Remains Sober

The miners' jaws drop lower and lower as they witness the sheer quantity of alcohol that you imbibe.

Miner: *All right, all right, you win! You adventurers must have iron constitutions to put away that much ale!*

If the Adventurer Becomes Tipsy

As the miners grow more and more tipsy, they begin to slap each other on the back, cheer, and launch into impromptu ditties. The miner who challenged you to this contest lets out a big belly laugh and says:

Miner: *Gahaha! Once you've downed a keg or two with someone, you have their measure! You're good folk in me book, an' me newest buddies to boot! So, what d'ye wanna know, friends?*

If the Adventurer Becomes Drunk

Have the player roll 1d6, then refer to the table below to determine the effects. These effects continue for roughly one bell of in-game time, though they do not impose any penalties on checks made by that character.

Drunkenness Table (1d6)

1. Immediately falls asleep on the spot (can be easily roused by another adventurer)
2. Begins laughing uncontrollably
3. Bursts into drunken tears
4. Slurs speech
5. Berates someone nearby
6. Becomes angry at another adventurer (but remember to be nice to their player!)

After determining the effects of the drunkenness roll, the crowd cheers, and the miner who challenged you to this drinking contest looks pleased with himself.

Miner: *Impressed, huh? Me pappy always said, "Never challenge a miner to a drinkin' contest unless you want a hammer of a headache the next morn'!" That bein' said, we're drinkin' buddies now, so...what was it you wanted to know, friend?*

Any adventurers who took part in the drinking contest earn the title "Mine Drinkin' Buddy." See page 22 of the Player Book for more information on titles. This title grants no special effects or abilities.

Whatever the results of the drinking contest, the miners now happily—and drunkenly—respond to any questions about the monster attacks and can provide the following information:

- ▶ For the last three days, the miners have been hearing sporadic booms that sound something like cannon fire ringing out from the direction of Raubahn's Push.
- ▶ These blasts are so loud, even people working inside the Ceruleum Processing Plant can hear them over the din of machinery.
- ▶ These sounds seem to have frightened the monsters nearby, who all began acting strangely after the first was heard. The miners haven't seen a single creature venture north of the plant ever since.

Flame Overseer (Roegadyn Man)

If the adventurers tell the overseer that Raubahn or Cracked Fist sent them to investigate, they can learn the following information without making any checks:

Flame Overseer: *Our lookouts reported a magitek conveyor landing in Castrum Meridianum three days ago. Ever since, the imperials have tightened their security and doubled their patrols. Raubahn's Push is practically crawling with soldiers and their warmachina.*

ASSEMBLING THE PIECES

Once the party has gathered enough clues, ask them to review the information they've acquired. At this point, they should know that three days ago, a magitek conveyor arrived at Castrum Meridianum. Since then, the imperial forces have increased their presence in the region, and strange blasts resembling cannon fire have been heard. That appears to be what caused the monsters to enter their current frenzied state.

When the players have finished their investigation, the adventurers hear a thunderous roar peal out from the north. Have each character make an **INT** check with a CR of 10. If any of them succeed, they can tell that this noise is in fact an amalgam of two distinct sounds being produced simultaneously: a monster's roar and some sort of warmachina engine screaming to life.

If all of the characters fail the check, they do not infer any additional information.



Magitek Conveyor

MAGITEK BIT ALERT

To investigate the noise, the party must travel through Raubahn's Push. Imperial patrols crisscross the area, forcing the adventurers to proceed cautiously. Eventually, they find a weak point in the imperial defenses, but in order to break through, they must defeat a magitek vanguard, two Cohort laquearii, and two Cohort signiferi while magitek bits swoop around the perimeter. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ Raubahn's Push is crawling with imperial forces on high alert. To investigate the sound you heard, you'll need to proceed cautiously and find a way through the imperial lines.

As you move swiftly and stealthily northwards, you locate a route sheltered from the enemy's watchful eyes. Unfortunately, the imperials are well aware of this vulnerability in their defenses. Ahead, you see two imperial soldiers with axes and two with staves accompanied by a magitek vanguard, all standing watch over your sole means of ingress. The guards are alert, so you won't be able to sneak past them. However, if you can defeat them quickly and quietly, you should be able to penetrate the enemy lines.

There is a catch: magitek bits are present throughout the area, and you will need to avoid them before engaging the troops barring your path. You may be able to sneak past these sentries, or deduce their patrol routes and evade them that way.

Have each character make a check to evade the magitek bits. Players who want their adventurer to sneak past will use **DEX** for their check, and players who want their adventurer to deduce and avoid the enemy patrol routes will use **INT** for their check. The CR of both checks is 20, but this should not be revealed to the players.

Regardless of success, the adventurers manage to avoid the magitek bits. If even a single adventurer succeeds, however, the party takes the enemy by surprise in the next encounter.

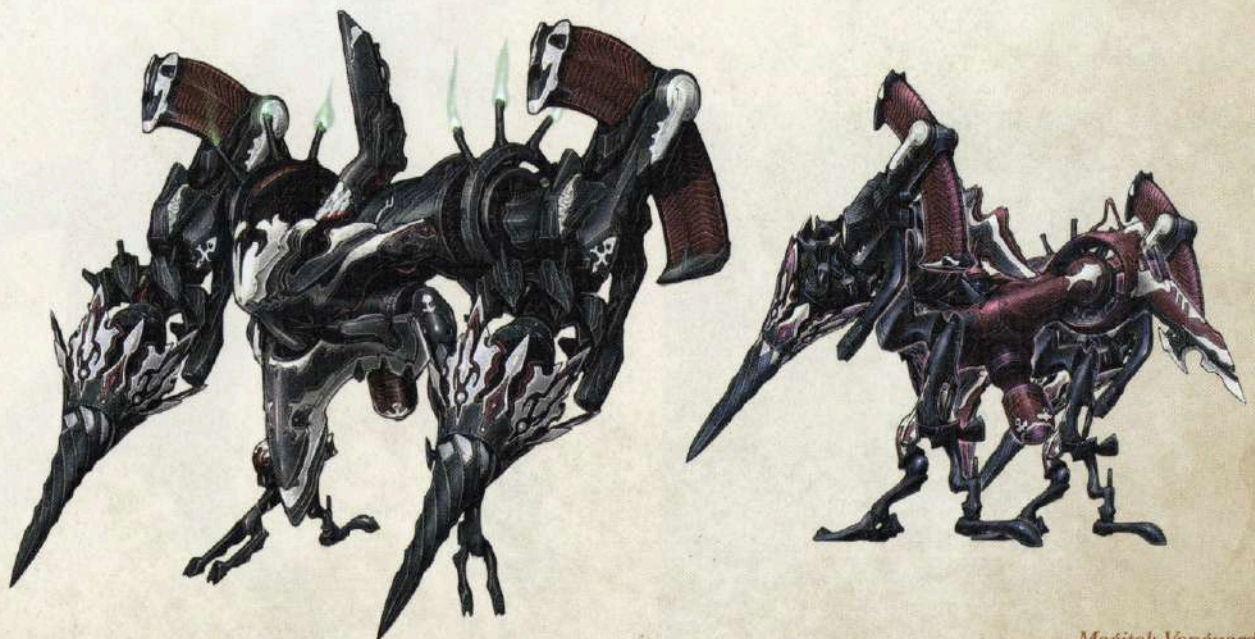


If a player wishes to destroy any magitek bits, they may do so easily and without making any checks. However, the sound of any magitek bit's destruction will draw the attention of the soldiers, immediately initiating the following encounter.

BREAKING THROUGH

☞ **Imperial Soldier:** *Halt, who goes there!? ...Intruders!? Don't let any of them escape! Our orders are clear: no word of the experiment is to get out, or it's our heads!*

When they realize they are under attack, the imperial soldiers quickly down bottles of fortis and draw their weapons. Prepare for battle!



Magitek Vanguard

Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Cohort Laquearius x2 (L)
2. Cohort Signifer x2 (S)
3. Magitek Vanguard x1 (V)

If any of the adventurers succeed on their checks to avoid the magitek bits, their enemies are surprised and unable to act during the first round of the encounter. In this case, consider the following round to be round 1 for the purpose of determining enemy tactics.

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Cohort Laquearius: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Heavy Swing → Overpower)**.

- **Heavy Swing:** Target the nearest non-tank adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- **Overpower:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible, regardless of whether a tank has **Enmity** on this character. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

Cohort Signifer: Attack the most distant adventurer twice using **Thunder**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Magitek Vanguard: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Drill → Drill → Cermet Drill)**.

- **Drill:** Target the nearest non-tank adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- **Cermet Drill:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, attack the tank and as many other enemies as possible instead. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

Round 2

Cohort Laquearius: Same as round 1.

Cohort Signifer: Attack the most distant adventurer using **Paralyze**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Magitek Vanguard: Same as round 1.



On all subsequent rounds, enemies will alternate between the tactics outlined for rounds 1 and 2.

ENCOUNTER DATA

COHORT LAQUEARIUS

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 15	Magic Defense: 13
Max HP: 40	Speed: 5 squares
STR +4	DEX +2
VIT +5	INT +0
MND +1	

Abilities

Combo Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Heavy Swing**, perform an optional standard movement action, then immediately use **Overpower**.

Heavy Swing Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Overpower Primary, Stationary Marker, Physical

Origin: A square occupied by this character

Marker Area: A stationary 5x5 area

centered on the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 2d6 + 5 damage to all targets.



COHORT SIGNIFER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 14

Defense: 11

Magic Defense: 15

Max HP: 30

Speed: 5 squares

STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+0	+2	+1	+5	+4

Abilities

INVK Thunder *Primary, Magic, Lightning-Aspected, Invoked*

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage and inflicts a **DOT (3)** on the target. This character can use **Thunder** once more at any point during this turn.**INVK Paralyze** *Primary, Magic, Invoked*

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Inflicts the **Paralysis** enfeeblement on the target, which has the following effects:

- If a **Paralyzed** character uses a *primary* ability and rolls a 5 or lower for its ability check, **Paralysis** interrupts the ability, negating it completely. Do not resolve any of its effects, including its base effect. If the interrupted ability has a limited number of uses, none of its uses are consumed and the character may attempt to use the ability again on a later turn.
- **Paralysis** is removed at the end of the **Paralyzed** character's turn.

MAGITEK VANGUARD

Size: Large (2x2) - Forgekin

Vigilance: 12

Defense: 14

Magic Defense: 12

Max HP: 75

Speed: 6 squares

STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+7	+3	+4	+0	+2

Abilities

Combo *Primary, Unique*Base Effect: Attack twice using **Drill**, perform an optional standard movement action, then immediately use **Cermet Drill**.**Drill** *Primary, Physical*

Target: Single Range: 2 squares

Check: STR (d20 + 7) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 7 damage to the target.

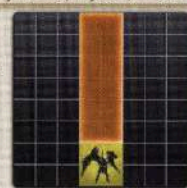
Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

INVK Cermet Drill *Primary, Stationary Marker, Physical, Invoked*

Marker Area: A stationary 2x6 area extending in a straight line from two directly adjacent squares on one side of the character

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn



Marker Effect: Deals 5d6 damage to all targets.

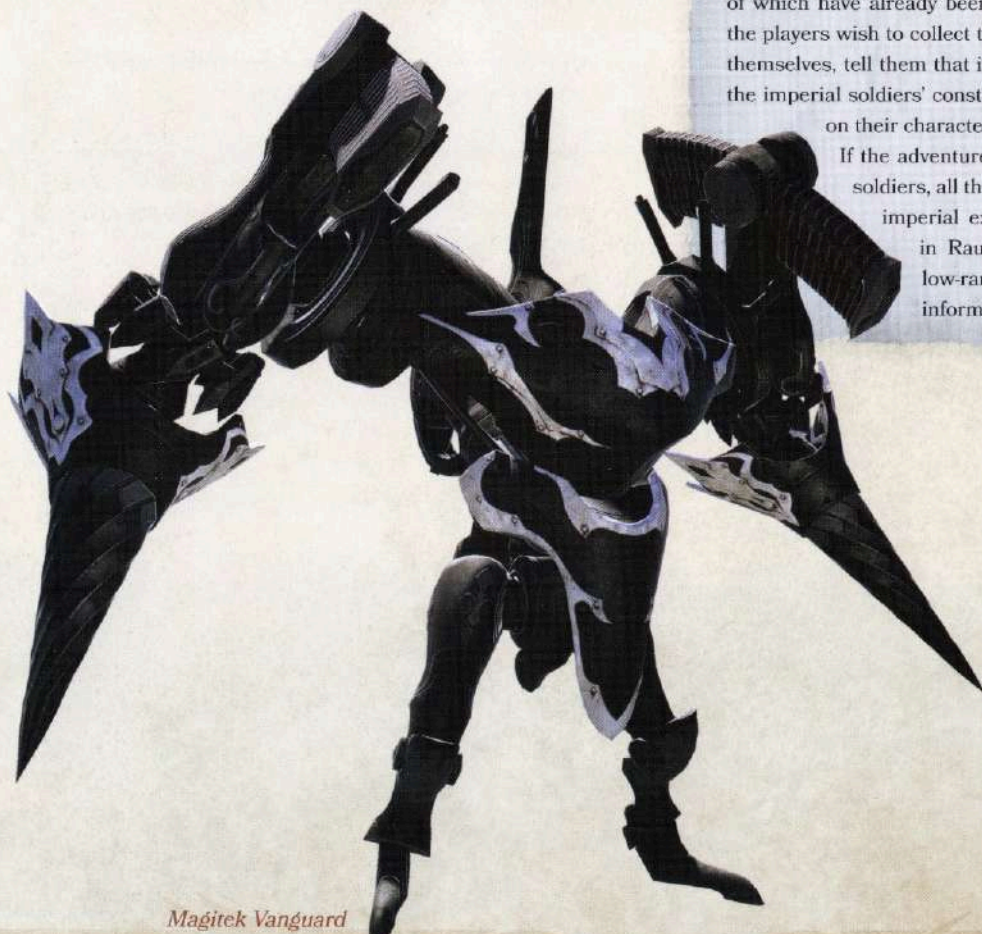
Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when all enemies have been reduced to 0 HP. Once this occurs, read the passage on the next page aloud for the other players.



The Cohort laquearii and Cohort signiferi used fortis before the encounter began to enhance their abilities, the effects of which have already been applied to the enemy data. If the players wish to collect their fallen foes' fortis to use for themselves, tell them that it has been brewed specially for the imperial soldiers' constitutions, and will have no effect on their characters.

If the adventurers capture and interrogate the soldiers, all the prisoners can reveal is that an imperial experiment is underway deeper in Raubahn's Push. They are simply low-ranking sentries, and have no new information to offer the players.



Magitek Vanguard

HELLISH EXPERIMENTS

☞ You break through the imperial lines and make it into the northernmost reaches of Raubahn's Push. Ahead lies a set of tracks linking Castrum Meridianum to the Empire's other strongholds on Eorzean soil. Ranks and ranks of imperial soldiers stand at attention before the gates to the castrum, though to what end, you know not.

The adventurers have reached the testing grounds for the newly developed Mark II hellscrawl, which is undergoing a live-fire exercise that pits it against a fearsome gorgimera. The roar and clash of their combat is almost certainly what is terrifying the local monsters, causing them to stampede south towards Camp Bluefog.

The Mark II hellscrawl is almost identical to the standard model, but with an unusual laser cannon installed in the tip of one of its fingers. This laser is a prototype that will eventually be wielded by the magitek scorpion in Scenario 3.

When the adventurers approach the testing grounds, read the following cutscene aloud for the other players. Once finished, immediately initiate the combat encounter described on the next page.

Note that in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG, player characters are unable to take action or otherwise intervene during cutscenes.

Cutscene

☞ As you edge closer, another deafening blast rings out from nearby. You step from the shadow of a rocky outcrop to discover a terrifying sight: a massive three-headed monster the size of a house locked in a fierce struggle with a warmachina. Clearly this clash is the reason for the gathering of imperial soldiers, who stand watching the battle unfold with equal parts fascination and fear.

Your eyes are immediately drawn to the creature's grotesque form. The heads of a monstrous lion, dragon, and goat each roar and snap their jaws, while sinister bat wings beat from where they sprout out of its muscled back. You've heard of this beast before—the gorgimera!

The warmachina is familiar to you, and as such less impressive: a hellscrawl, an imperial machine wrought in the shape of a hand.

Hold a moment... You look closer, and see that one of the hellscrawl's six fingers is constructed out of pleated layers

of articulated metal, with what appears to be a magitek laser barrel protruding from its tip. You've seen hellscrawls before, but never any like this.

As you watch, the hellscrawl points its pleated finger towards the gorgimera. A massive charge of energy gathers at its fingertip, and with a earsplitting keen, it fires a blast that strikes its opponent dead on! The gorgimera, mortally wounded, lets out one final piercing shriek and collapses to the ground.

As the monster falls, the cadre of magitek engineers observing the spectacle raise an excited cheer. One voice can be heard clearly over the rest.

Magitek Engineer: *What power! What might! To think our creation would dispatch that beastly gorgimera with such ease! The test of the prototype magitek laser is a stunning success, and we are now one step closer to realizing our goal—a new generation of magitek weaponry to surpass all that have come before!*

Their chests puffed with pride, the engineers heartily congratulate each other, while the pompous fellow you heard exclaim so effusively steps forward to report to what appears to be the officer in charge.

Magitek Engineer: *Galba lux Pulcher, sir! Is our creation to your liking?*

The officer—Galba—responds with a pleased nod.

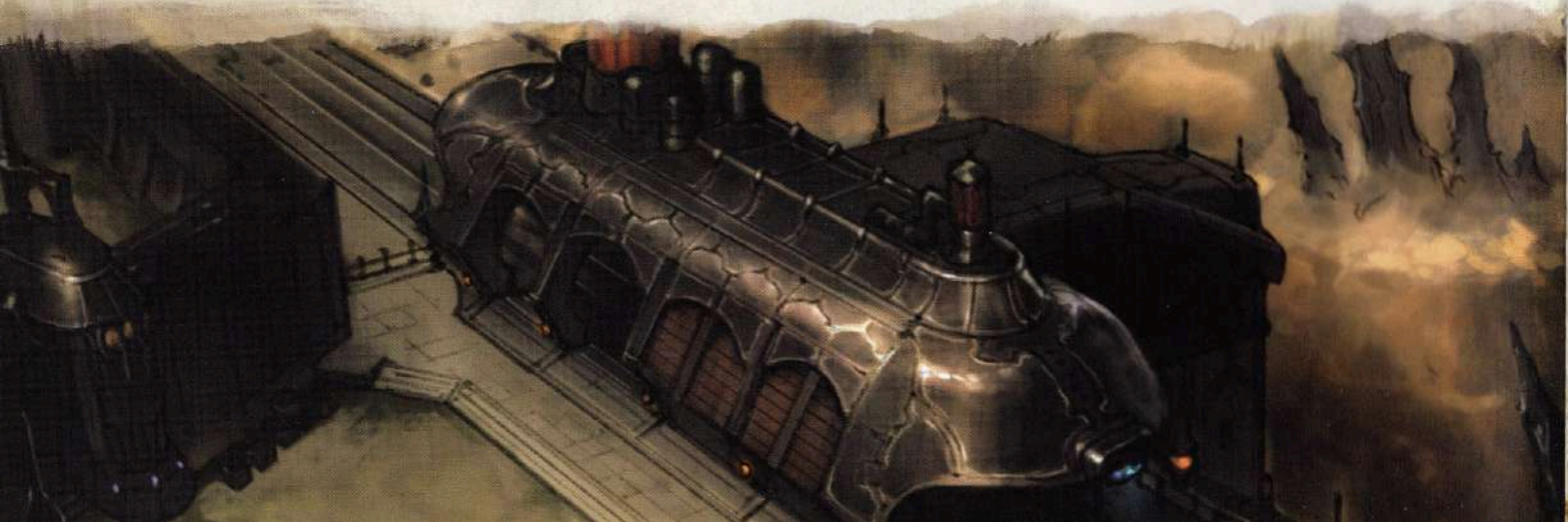
Galba: *Yes, I am more than satisfied with its performance. With this new weapon in our hands, it is only a matter of time before those pesky Eorzean barbarians are swept aside by our righteous might!*

With a malevolent smirk, Galba turns toward where you thought you had been safely concealed.

Galba: *Speaking of those wretched fools, it appears we have a few of the rats in our midst. Send the hellscrawl to dispose of them. Their screams will add a delightful bow atop today's stunning success.*

Galba extends a hand in your direction, and the imperial soldiers, unaware of your presence until that moment, hurriedly draw their weapons and down bottles of fortis. They quickly encircle your position, but you are more concerned with the hellscrawl that is bearing straight down upon you! Prepare for battle!

Castrum Meridianum





Preparing the Encounter (Phase 1)

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Cohort Eques x2 (E)
2. Cohort Signifer x2 (S)
3. Mark II Hellsclaw - Standard Mode x1 (H)

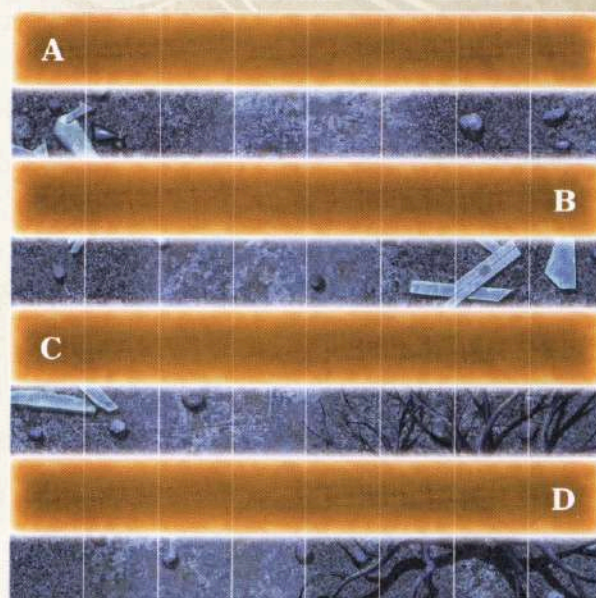
The imperial engineers, non-combat staff, and Galba will not participate in this combat encounter.

Before the encounter begins, explain its mechanics to the other players. After describing how Magitek Bit Formation works, ask them to determine their turn order, then use the timeline detailed below to advance the encounter, starting with round 1.

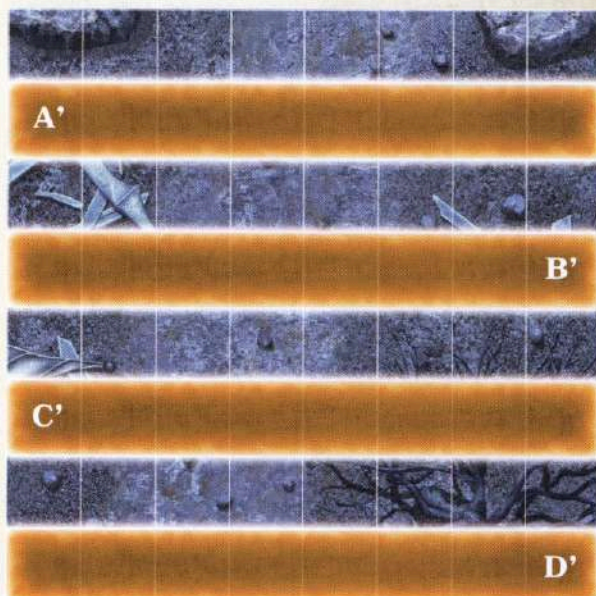
Encounter Mechanic: Magitek Bit Formation

When the encounter starts, four magitek bits appear at locations A through D, as shown in the Formation 1 diagram. Immediately after a round begins, these magitek bits each generate markers on the encounter map.

The magitek bits cannot be attacked or destroyed in any way; however, an adventurer may move into a magitek bit's square and use a secondary action to remove the marker it generated this round, canceling its attack.



Formation 1



Formation 2

Magitek Bit *Stationary Marker, Magic*

Marker Area: A stationary 1x8 area extending in a straight line from the square occupied by this character

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The end of the current round

Marker Effect: Deals 3d6 + 2 damage to all targets.



Gorgimera

Encounter Timeline & Enemy Tactics

The hellscaw and imperial soldiers will act according to the tactics described below.

Round 1

Beginning of Round

Place the four magitek bits in locations A through D, then place a stationary marker on the encounter map for each of them. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

As the hellscaw charges, it launches four magitek bits from ports on its chassis. These bits quickly flit to encircle you, two on each side, and you can see their weapons begin to glow with an angry blue light.

Cohort Eques: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (True Thrust → Heartstopper)**.

- **True Thrust:** Target the nearest non-tank adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- **Heartstopper:** Place the marker on the tank. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

Cohort Signifer: Attack the most distant adventurer twice using **Thunder**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Mark II Hellscaw - Standard Mode: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Shred → Smash)**.

- **Shred:** Target the nearest non-tank adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- **Smash:** Place the marker to attack the tank and as many other enemies as possible.

The first time the hellscaw uses **Smash**, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

The Mark II hellscaw curls its fingers into a fist, hovers high into the air, then rockets down to squash you like bugs!

End of Round

Trigger the magitek bits' markers and resolve their effects.



Cohort Eques

Round 2

Beginning of Round

Move the four magitek bits to locations A' through D' as shown in the Formation 2 diagram, then place a stationary marker on the encounter map for each of them.

The magitek bits cleverly shift their formation to hem you in even further!

Cohort Eques: Same as round 1.

Cohort Signifer: Attack the most distant adventurer using **Paralyze**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, or if the tank is not currently **Paralyzed**, target the tank instead.

Mark II Hellscaw - Standard Mode: Approach the nearest adventurer and attack using **Combo (Shred → Prototype Magitek Laser)**.

- **Shred:** Target the nearest non-tank adventurer. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.
- **Prototype Magitek Laser:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible, regardless of whether a tank has **Enmity** on this character. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

The first time the hellscaw uses **Prototype Magitek Laser**, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

The Mark II hellscaw points its finger at you, and the tip begins to glow with a baleful light. This is the same position it assumed immediately before it fired the laser that felled the gorgimera in one devastating blow!

End of Round

Trigger the magitek bits' markers and resolve their effects.

Round 3+

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will alternate between the tactics outlined for rounds 1 and 2.

Magitek Bit Formation: At the beginning of each odd-numbered round, the magitek bits will return to the positions described in round 1. On even-numbered rounds, they will move to those indicated in round 2.

ENCOUNTER DATA

COHORT SIGNIFER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 14

Defense: 11 Magic Defense: 15
 Max HP: 30 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +0 +2 +1 +5 +4

Abilities

INVK Thunder Primary, Magic, Lightning-Aspected, Invoked

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage and inflicts a DOT (3) on the target. This character can use **Thunder** once more at any point during this turn.

INVK Paralyze Primary, Magic, Invoked

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Inflicts the **Paralysis** enfeeblement on the target, which has the following effects:

- If a **Paralyzed** character uses a *primary* ability and rolls a 5 or lower for its ability check, **Paralysis** interrupts the ability, negating it completely. Do not resolve any of its effects, including its base effect. If the interrupted ability has a limited number of uses, none of its uses are consumed and the character may attempt to use the ability again on a later turn.

- **Paralysis** is removed at the end of the **Paralyzed** character's turn.

COHORT EQUUS

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 15 Magic Defense: 13
 Max HP: 40 Speed: 5 squares
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +5 +3 +2 +1 +1

Abilities

Combo Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **True Thrust**, perform an optional standard movement action, then immediately use **Heartstopper**.

True Thrust Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 5) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Heartstopper Primary, Stationary Marker, Physical

Marker Area: A stationary 1x3 area extending in a straight line from a square adjacent to this character

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 4d6 damage to all targets.

MARK II HELLSCLAW - STANDARD MODE

Size: Large (2x2) - Forgekin

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 14 Magic Defense: 16
 Max HP: 110 Speed: 6 squares (flying)
 STR DEX VIT INT MND
 +7 +3 +6 +3 +1

Traits

Elite Foe: Prototype Warmachina

This character cannot be **Stunned**, and markers they have generated cannot be removed. Be sure to inform the players of this before beginning the encounter.

Abilities

Combo Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Shred**, perform an optional standard movement action, then immediately use **Smash** or **Prototype Magitek Laser**.

Shred Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 2 squares

Check: STR (d20 + 7) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 8 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Smash Primary, Mobile Marker, Physical

Origin: 1 enemy tank

Marker Area: A mobile 5x5 area centered on the origin that moves with the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn



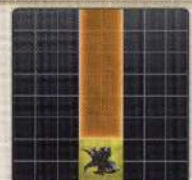
Marker Effect: Deals 5d6 damage divided evenly (rounded up) amongst all targets.

INVK Prototype Magitek Laser Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic, Invoked

Marker Area: A stationary 2x10 area extending in a straight line from two directly adjacent squares on one side of the character

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn



Marker Effect: Deals 6d6 + 6 damage to all targets.



Mark II Hellsclaw

Transitioning to Phase 2

The encounter transitions to its second phase once the Hellsclaw has been reduced to 0 HP. This occurs either at the end of the [Adventurer Step] or the [Enemy Step], whichever comes first. Before the second phase begins, remove any remaining Cohort Signiferi and Cohort Equites from the encounter map.

Read the following text, then initiate the second phase of the encounter:

☞ The Mark II hellscrawl reels from your many blows, its surface a lattice of dents and cracks. But the fight isn't over yet! A blaring, discordant siren screams into life from within the damaged warmachina as energy begins to pulse with uncontrolled menace.

At the sound of the siren, the pompous engineer from earlier races back to Galba with a crisp imperial salute.

Magitek Engineer: *Sir, it's too dangerous to remain here! We must retreat, or our lives will be forfeit!*

Galba: *Bah... Very well, if we must.*

The soldiers surrounding you panic, most dropping their weapons as they flee haphazardly in all directions. Galba lux Pulcher pulls a small device from his belt, fiddles with it for a moment, and then nimbly leaps into a magitek conveyor that swiftly descends from the sky.

Preparing the Encounter (Phase 2)

Enemy Placement: Mark II Hellscrawl - Berserk Mode x1 (H)

The magitek bits are destroyed at the start of this phase and will no longer interfere with the battle.

At the beginning of the first round of Phase 2, the Mark II hellscrawl uses its *instant* ability, **Berserk**. When it does, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ The rampaging Mark II hellscrawl unleashes an explosive blast of uncontrollable energy, destroying the magitek bits that had been buzzing around you and sending both the corpse of the gorgimera and the slagged remains of discarded warmachina flying in all directions. You too are buffeted by this storm of energy, and it is all you can do to remain on your feet.

At this point in the scenario, the adventurers can use their limit breaks. Make sure to inform the players of this now.

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Mark II Hellscrawl: Attack using **Missile Barrage** (**Fore Missile** → **Aft Missile**).

☞ **Fore Missile:** Attempt to hit as many enemies as possible. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, attack the tank and as many other enemies as possible instead. Use this character's standard movement to reposition if necessary.

☞ **Aft Missile:** Place up to 2 markers on squares occupied by DPS.

Round 2

Mark II Hellscrawl: Attack using **Frenzy** (**Nova Blast** → **Enhanced Smash**).

☞ **Nova Blast:** Attempt to hit as many enemies as possible.

☞ **Enhanced Smash:** Place the marker on the healer, regardless of whether a tank has **Enmity** on this character.

ENCOUNTER DATA

MARK II HELLSCLAW - BERSERK MODE

Size: Large (2x2) - Forgekin

Vigilance: 11

Defense: 13

Magic Defense: 15

Max HP: 160

Speed: 6 squares (flying)

STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+7	+3	+6	+3	+1

Traits

Elite Foe: Prototype Warmachina

This character cannot be **Stunned**, and markers they have generated cannot be removed. Be sure to inform the players of this before beginning the encounter.

Abilities

Berserk

Instant, Unique

Trigger: At the start of phase 2, immediately before the [Adventurer Step] begins

Base Effect: Deals 10 damage and inflicts a **DOT (5)** on all enemies on the encounter map. Adventurers cannot be brought below 1 HP by the 10 damage portion of this attack.

Missile Barrage

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Fore Missile**, then immediately use **Aft Missile**.

Fore Missile

Primary, Physical

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 3x3 area adjacent to this character

Check: STR (d20 + 7)

CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 8 damage to all targets.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Aft Missile

Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic

Origin: Up to 2 squares occupied by DPS

Marker Area: Up to 2 stationary 3x3 areas, one centered on each origin

Target: All enemies within the marker areas

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 4d6 + 5 damage to all targets.

Frenzy

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Nova Blast**, then immediately use **Enhanced Smash**.

INV Nova Blast

Primary, Magic, Invoked

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 4x4 area centered on this character

Check: STR (d20 + 7)

CR: Target's Magic Defense

Base Effect: Deals 8 damage to all targets.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage and forces targets to move 3 squares in any one direction.

Enhanced Smash

Primary, Mobile Marker, Physical

Origin: 1 enemy healer

Marker Area: A mobile 5x5 area centered on the origin that moves with the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 7d6 damage divided evenly (rounded up) amongst all targets.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when the hellscaw has been reduced to 0 HP. It explodes in a burst of incandescent flames, and the imperial troops are forced to abort the test and withdraw from the area.

GALBA'S IGNOMINIOUS RETREAT

Galba lux Pulcher has been safely observing the fight from his magitek conveyor high above the battlefield. When he sees that the hellscaw has been destroyed, he flies away. After the encounter ends, read the following cutscene aloud for the other players to describe this turn of events:

Cutscene

Galba lux Pulcher has been observing the battle from the safety of his magitek conveyor high above the ground. When his warmachina falls to your heroic efforts, his face contorts in a thundercloud of fury.

Galba: *Bloody Eorzean savages! You have stymied my plans not once, but twice now. I will not forgive nor forget your insults. Mark my words, you have not heard the last of me!*

With those ominous words, Galba's conveyor speeds off into the distance.

Galba lux Pulcher



REPORTING BACK TO RAUBAHN

After claiming victory, the adventurers leave northern Thanalan and return to Ul'dah to meet with Raubahn at the Hall of Flames. Raubahn is shocked when the adventurers describe what took place, vows to take steps to oppose imperial aggression, and thanks the adventurers for a job well done. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:



Raubahn Aldynn

You return to the Hall of Flames in Ul'dah to report back to Raubahn. When he learns that the cause of the disturbance was an imperial weapons test in northern Thanalan, his brow furrows in concern.

Raubahn: *So the Empire was testing a deadly new weapon... The imperials grow bolder every day, and Eorzea must see to its defenses if it wishes to remain free of their tyranny.*

But first, we owe you a debt of gratitude. On behalf of all Ul'dah, you have my thanks.

Raubahn gives you a broad, friendly smile...which quickly fades, replaced by an expression of fierce determination.

Raubahn: *The Garleans have forced our hand. Listen well, for the information I am about to reveal is of the utmost secrecy. Do not breathe a word of it to another soul.*

The three city-states of Eorzea have agreed to resurrect the Eorzean Alliance to resist the incursions of the Garlean Empire. When announced, it will be a momentous event, sure to leave its mark on history. I tell you this because I would ask you to join our ranks. Think it over. We could use skilled and resourceful warriors such as yourselves on our side.

THE ADVENTURE CONTINUES

The adventure continues with Scenario 3: Heroes of Operation Archon, in which the adventurers are called upon to join the ranks of the Eorzean Alliance as they mount a counteroffensive to drive the Garlean Empire from the realm.

Scenario 3 is intended for a party of four level 50 adventurers. You may assume that any characters who participated in this scenario have completed several other quests before Scenario 3 begins, allowing them to reach the required level.

TO BE CONTINUED...



SCENARIO 3: HEROES OF OPERATION ARCHON

An Eorzean Scenario, Recommended for a Light Party of Level 50 Adventurers

The average expected playtime for this scenario is four to five hours, or three to four hours for parties of experienced TTRPG players. When following the scenario as intended, the party will take part in three combat encounters and one mini-game.

This scenario is intended as a continuation of both Scenario 1: The Crystal Caper and Scenario 2: Imperial Machinations, and as such, it is recommended that the same players and adventurers set off on this particular journey. If you plan to play this scenario as a standalone story or with different players or adventurers, feel free to rephrase or adjust the story to better fit the situation.

The GM should review this scenario in full before beginning the game. To avoid spoiling the story, other players should refrain from reading the information contained here in advance.



SCENARIO SYNOPSIS (GM'S NOTES)

The party has joined the ranks of the Eorzean Alliance as it forges ahead with Operation Archon, the realm's united front against the Garlean Empire. Day after day, they fight valiantly to ensure that Eorzea remains free.

But ill tidings have come from the front line: the Order of the Twin Adder's forces have been devastated by a mysterious and lethal warmachina. Their assault on Castrum Oriens has faltered, and without reinforcements, their prong of the Eorzean offensive is almost certain to end in failure. If this should come to pass, it would endanger the entire operation.

Cellica Flame—captain of one of the Alliance's elite adventurer units—tasks the party with destroying the Empire's new weapon. After accepting her request, they set out for Castrum Oriens to rescue their embattled allies.

The Order of the Twin Adder's forces have suffered heavy losses at Castrum Oriens, and to pour oil onto the flames, a giant ochu named Lazy Laurence assails their flank soon after the party arrives.

The adventurers are asked to step forward and beat back the stampeding seedkin. They are given little time to rest after it finally falls, for a sylph comes rushing onto the scene to report that imperial forces have launched an assault on Little Solace. The adventurers depart to repel the imperials, only to learn of yet another setback—in the confusion of the battle, Elder Frixio of the sylphs has been captured by the enemy.

The heroes rush to rescue Frixio, but discover that a frightening warmachina awaits them: the magitek scorpion.

INTRODUCTION

Before starting this scenario, explain to the other players that the story is set shortly after the Eorzean Alliance launches Operation Archon, the grand counteroffensive against the Garlean Empire.

The adventure begins with the party, now fighting alongside the forces of the Eorzean Alliance, receiving dire news from an old friend—Cellica Flame.

NEVER FORTUNE WITHOUT MISFORTUNE

Once the players are ready to begin, read the following passage aloud. Feel free to rephrase or adjust the story to better fit the adventurers' backstories or profiles. For convenience's sake, this scenario assumes that the adventurers have already formed a party and are acquainted with each other.

☞ You are participating in Operation Archon, the Eorzean Alliance's grand counteroffensive against the Garlean Empire. You have fought the foe on many fronts, and your unit is now making its way towards Castrum Meridianum, a major imperial base of operations. Your spirits are high; recent news of Rhytahtyn sas Arvina's defeat has reached Allied ears, and victory seems within your grasp.

But war is a fickle mistress, and rarely does everything go according to plan. Word has just arrived from the Order of the Twin Adder contingent assaulting Castrum Oriens, and it is grim news indeed. The enemy has deployed some deadly new type of warmachina which inflicted heavy casualties on Allied forces and forced them back in disarray. If Castrum Oriens cannot be isolated once more, the key offensive on Castrum Meridianum will be imperiled.

Cellica Flame, leader of one of the Alliance's elite adventurer units, knows the reputation you command and comes seeking your skill and expertise.

Cellica: *We meet again, my brave adventurers. I come to you now with a request, in full confidence that you are equal to the task.*

I trust you have been apprised of the situation with the Order of the Twin Adder's forces? Their push on Castrum Oriens has been turned by a new type of warmachina.

I would ask that you make for their position and endeavor to salvage the situation by laying low this new imperial contrivance.

If the players accept this request, inform them the matter is urgent, and they must set out at once if they wish to arrive in time to aid the Twin Adders.



What to Do If the Party Refuses the Quest

If the players decide not to accept Cellica's request, pause the game and explain that this scenario is built around the assumption that the party will accept this task. Encourage them to do so, as the scenario cannot otherwise continue as designed.

Before setting off, if the players seek more information regarding the forces of the Eorzean Alliance or Operation Archon's overall progress, they can speak to Cellica and learn the following:

The Status of the Twin Adders

The Order of the Twin Adder is fighting a battle on two fronts. Elder Seedseer Kan-E-Senna leads a detachment blocking the supply lines from Mor Dhona to northern Thanalan, ensuring Castrum Centri cannot dispatch reinforcements to Castrum Meridianum.

Their remaining forces have secured the cooperation of the sylphs in the Black Shroud, and have thus far managed to apply enough pressure on Castrum Oriens to fully occupy its troops. However, the sudden arrival of a mysterious new warmachina has dealt them a grave blow, and they require immediate support.

The Status of Operation Archon

With the defeat of Rhitahtyn sas Arvina, morale continues to rise, and the battle turns in the Alliance's favor. It will all be for naught, however, should Allied forces fail to take Castrum Meridianum.

The New Warmachina

Alliance forces in the Black Shroud have encountered a new type of warmachina never yet seen before. The few soldiers that have survived an encounter with it report that it resembles a massive mechanized scorpion.



- **Cellica Flame:** An adventurer of great fame and renown, Cellica currently busies herself leading one of the Alliance's elite adventurer units.
 - **The Order of the Twin Adder:** Gridania's Grand Company, the Order of the Twin Adder provides a source of military strength for the embattled woodland city-state.
 - **Kan-E-Senna:** *Eldest of three siblings of Padjali blood, Kan-E-Senna serves as head of the Seedseer Council—the central governing body presiding over affairs within the city-state of Gridania.*
 - **Operation Archon:** When Eorzea's leaders resolved to fight Gaius van Baelsar and his Ultima Weapon, they turned their attentions to the matter of how best to coordinate their military might. So it was that Operation Archon was conceived—the largest single counteroffensive in the realm's troubled history, in which the Alliance would strike at every imperial stronghold standing upon Eorzean soil.
 - **Rhitahtyn sas Arvina:** Praefectus castrorum of the XIVth Imperial Legion and one of Legatus Legionis Gaius van Baelsar's most trusted officers. In this scenario, he has already been defeated by another band of adventurers.
 - **Castrum Oriens:** *Behind this Garlean outpost stands Baelsar's Wall, and behind that lies Gyr Abania—a region of the imperially occupied Ala Mhigo.*
 - **Castrum Centri:** The imperial army's stronghold in Mor Dhona, and an important strategic supply point for Castrum Meridianum.
 - **Castrum Meridianum:** *Castrum Meridianum is the southernmost stronghold of the XIVth Imperial Legion. Inside it stands the Praetorium, a fortress within a fortress and the command center of the invading legion. The castrum is also one stop of the Phantom Train, a monstrous machine used to transport ordinance to Castrum Centri in Mor Dhona.*
- Entries in italics from *Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~*



TO CASTRUM ORIENS

When the adventurers arrive in the East Shroud near Castrum Oriens, due south of Amarissaix's Spire, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ You have reached the East Shroud, site of Castrum Oriens and current location of the Order of the Twin Adder's forward camp. Imperial forces appear to have fallen back, bringing an uneasy moment of peace in the midst of the storm of battle. The air is alive with the sounds of people tending to the wounded and soldiers running hither and thither delivering supplies and messages.

As you search the camp for someone to report to, an Elezen woman in a serpent officer uniform catches sight of you and rushes over.

Serpent Officer: *You must be the party of adventurers we requested. I'm Louixon, Second Serpent Commander. Welcome to the East Shroud, wherein lies the object of our efforts—Castrum Oriens.*

If the adventurers inquire as to the current state of the battle, Louixon explains that her forces barely managed to stave off the first wave of the imperial assault, and that the enemy retreated into Castrum Oriens before the party arrived.

She is about to provide details about the new warmachina, but is cut short by an urgent linkpearl message. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ Louixon is about to continue when a faint, pulsing chime sounds. She glances at you with an apologetic look, then raises a hand to her ear with a sigh.

Louixon: *Yes, what is it?*

Unable to hear the speaker's response, you watch in silence as Louixon grows more and more agitated by the second.

Louixon: *Lazy Laurence!? The creature never comes out here! Gah, no matter. Direct the archers to keep it at bay, and have those still able of body see to the wounded!*

Having issued her orders, Louixon turns back to you, a worried expression writ plain across her face.

Louixon: *You are familiar with the creatures called ochus, I trust? Our forces are presently under attack by a particularly vicious specimen known locally as Lazy Laurence, and I'd like you to help them, if you're willing.*

If the Party Accepts the Request

Louixon and the adventurers race towards the site of the battle, ready to provide whatever aid they can.



What to Do If the Party Refuses the Quest

If the players decide not to accept Louixon's request, pause the game and explain that this scenario is built around the assumption that the party will accept this task. Feel free to add that if they don't help Louixon, the Order of the Twin Adder's forces will be wiped out and Operation Archon will end in failure—not an ideal outcome from their characters' point of view. Encourage them to accept the request, as the scenario cannot otherwise continue as designed.

LAZY FOR YOU

The party races alongside Second Serpent Commander Louixon to the order's northwest outpost, where Twin Adder forces have surrounded Lazy Laurence and a mass of smaller monsters. The brave soldiers are desperately attempting to keep the rancorous beasts away from the wounded and defenseless non-combatants, but are hard-pressed to keep the seedkin contained. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ When you arrive at the site of the conflict, you spy a massive creature with two enormous tentacles bearing down upon the serpent soldiers.

Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Lazy Laurence x1 (L) - Phase 1
2. Fruiting Fungus x6 (F) - Phase 2 only

Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Lazy Laurence: Use a standard movement to get within three squares of as many adventurers as possible and attack using **Combo (Hypha Whip → Acid Mist)**.

- ◆ **Hypha Whip:** Target two random enemies within range. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank and one random enemy within range instead.
- ◆ **Acid Mist:** Place the marker to attack as many enemies as possible. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, attack the tank and as many other enemies as possible instead.

Fruiting Fungus: Move into a position to hit as many adventurers as possible, and then attack using **Spore Spray**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, attempt to move as close to the tank as possible before attacking instead.

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will repeat the tactics outlined for round 1.





Do not place the fruiting fungi on the encounter map until the start of phase 2. If another character is present in a fruiting fungus's starting square, place the fruiting fungus in the nearest unoccupied square instead.

ENCOUNTER DATA

LAZY LAURENCE (PHASES 1 & 2)

Size: Huge (3x3) - Seedkin

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 15 Magic Defense: 14
Max HP: 180 Speed: 6 squares
STR +4 DEX +5 VIT +2 INT +1 MND +0

Abilities

Combo Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Hypha Whip**, then immediately use **Acid Mist**.

Hypha Whip Primary, Physical

Target: 2 characters. Range: 3 squares

Check: **DEX** (d20 + 5) CR: Target's **Defense**

Base Effect: Deals 9 damage and inflicts a **DOT (5)** on all targets if they are not already suffering from a **DOT**.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Acid Mist Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic, Invoked

Origin: A square occupied by this character

Marker Area: A stationary 5x5 area centered on the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 4d6 damage to all targets and inflicts the **Slow** enfeeblement, which has the following effects:

- A **Slowed** character has their **Speed** halved (rounded up) and cannot be affected by effects which would add to their **Speed**.
- A **Slowed** character incurs a -2 penalty on all checks.

Transitioning to Phase 2

The encounter transitions to its second phase once Lazy Laurence has been reduced to 0 HP. This occurs either at the end of the [Adventurer Step] or the [Enemy Step], whichever comes first.

When phase 2 begins, add 6 fruiting fungi to the encounter map and reset Lazy Laurence's HP. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

 Lazy Laurence whips its tentacles back and forth, and suddenly a gaggle of mushroom-like creatures springs up from the ground below!

FRUITING FUNGUS (PHASE 2 ONLY)

Size: Medium (1x1) - Seedkin

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 11 Magic Defense: 12
Max HP: 20 Speed: 4 squares
STR +1 DEX +1 VIT +2 INT +1 MND +0

Abilities

Volatile Reaction Instant

Trigger: When this character takes damage from an ability and is not reduced to 0 HP

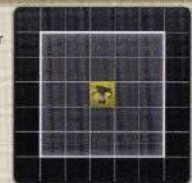
Base Effect: Immediately attack using **Spore Spray**.

Limitation: Once per round

Spore Spray Primary, Physical

Target: All enemies within range

Range: A 5x5 area centered on this character



Base Effect: Deals 3 damage and inflicts a **DOT (5)** on all targets if they are not already suffering from a **DOT**.



Fruiting Fungus

Ending the Encounter

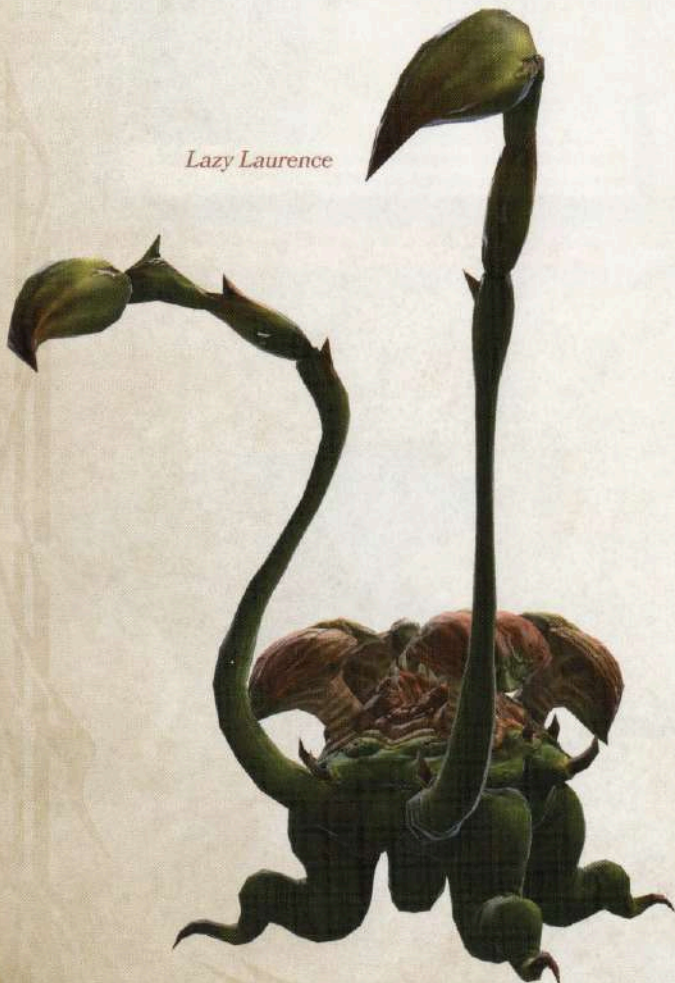
The encounter ends when Lazy Laurence has been reduced to 0 HP, even if there are fruiting fungi left on the encounter map. The adventurer who deals the finishing blow discovers an empty ampoule with the imperial emblem engraved on it stuck to Lazy Laurence's backside.

Louixon: *You made that look positively effortless—few who bore witness to your heroics here today would doubt your reputation is well earned. Our people owe you a debt of gratitude for your valor. Now then, let us return to camp.*

If the players inform Louixon about the ampoule discovered on Lazy Laurence, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

Louixon: *Could the imperials have used whatever drug was in this to drive the poor creature into a frenzy and send it rampaging our way? Mayhap their withdrawal was but temporary, to afford them time enough to thin our ranks with this scheme? Never a thorn in our side more cunning than these Garleans...*

Any adventurers who participated in this encounter earn the title "Lazy for Laurence." See page 22 of the Player Book for more information on titles.



Lazy Laurence

SYLPHS IN CRISIS

After the battle with Lazy Laurence, the adventurers are led to the Order of the Twin Adder's forward base in the East Shroud. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

Louixon: *As you make your way into the Order of the Twin Adder's forward base, you are greeted with loud cheers and applause.*

Louixon gives you a warm smile and raises her voice to be heard above the din.

Louixon: *As I said earlier, you'll find that few doubt your skill here. Now, let's waste no time. I shall apprise you of the situation.*

Our forces joined with the sylphs and blockaded Castrum Oriens on its Black Shroud flank. Our aim, as you know, was to prevent them from sending reinforcements to Castrum Meridianum. However, we were taken unawares by a new model of imperial warmachina, which launched a devastating assault upon us.

Fortuitously, the weapon withdrew to Castrum Oriens in the midst of the battle, and we were able to mount an offensive and push the imperial forces back—for now.

Alas, we still lost one soldier in five, and we are now desperately working to regroup and reorder our ranks.

A pensive look clouds Louixon's face as she relays this information.

If the players ask Louixon for more information on the warmachina, they can learn the following:

Warmachina Intel

The warmachina resembles a giant red scorpion, with autocannons fitted where its pincers should be and a laser cannon installed in its tail. The weapon was also able to emit a powerful burst of energy around it, which inflicted heavy damage on the Twin Adder forces that attempted to surround it.

Reasons for the Weapon's Retreat

The true reason for the weapon's retreat remains unknown. Perhaps it was so that the imperials could use Lazy Laurence to disrupt Allied operations, or perhaps it needed maintenance or to be resupplied.

After the adventurers have finished asking questions, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

Sylph: *Before you can decide your next course of action, a sylph springs from the brush nearby and darts over to you.*

Sylph: *This one... This one is at loose ends with worry! Red one... Little Solace...!*

The sylph is terribly agitated, and flits back and forth while sputtering nigh-incoherently. Alas, she is so distraught that you cannot make heads or tails of what she's trying to say.

The sylph can be calmed by making a **MND** or **VIT** check with a CR of 12. Once a check is made—regardless of success—the sylph regains her composure and explains the situation to the party.

Reveal the following information to the party:

- ◆ The sylph says her name is Solquxia.
- ◆ The imperials are attacking Little Solace.
- ◆ There is a large warmachina that resembles a scorpion participating in the attack.

If any of the adventurers succeed on their **MND** or **VIT** checks, Solquxia gives the party two vials of Ether as thanks for their kindness.



Ether

Secondary, Consumable

Target: Self

Base Effect: Restores 1 MP to the target. Discard after use.



- ◆ **Little Solace:** *Little is the solace granted to those sylphs who would voice their opposition to the summoning of the Lord of Levin. Little is the solace bequeathed upon those who would abandon their homes in the Sylphlands and shun their frenzied brethren. Thus, it is only through fraternity that those sylphs may ultimately find solace, however little it may be.*

—Encyclopædia Eorzea ~The World of Final Fantasy XIV~

☞ **Solquxia:** *Walking ones must help! This one's home faces a threat most grave!*

Louixon: *The imperials have attacked Little Solace? Something must be done, and quickly—we can ill afford to lose the sylphs' encampment! Without their support, our mission to blockade Castrum Oriens is as good as lost. Adventurers, please make for Little Solace and aid in its defense!*

If the Party Accepts the Request

The adventurers immediately make for Little Solace.



What to Do If the Party Refuses the Quest

If the players decide not to accept Louixon's request, pause the game and explain that this scenario is built around the assumption that the party will accept this task. Feel free to add that if they don't help Louixon, the Order of the Twin Adder's forces will be wiped out and Operation Archon will end in failure—not an ideal outcome from their characters' point of view. Encourage them to accept the request, as the scenario cannot otherwise continue as designed.



Sylph

LITTLE SOLACE

The adventurers arrive in Little Solace and are greeted with the sight of panicked sylphs fleeing in terror. Imperial soldiers chase them this way and that, brandishing their weapons menacingly all the while.

☞ Garlean soldiers have overrun the area, and pursue the terrified sylphs with weapons drawn. You notice that the imperials are not attacking the sylphs—it seems they've decided it would be easier to simply scare them off.

Sylphs: *EEEE! HEEELP!*

Imperial Soldier: *Gahaha! Yes, flee in terror! This land belongs to the Empire now!*

Solquxia: *This one begs walking ones! These ones cannot lose another home!*

Preparing the Encounter

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Cohort Hoplomachus x2 (H)
2. Cohort Secutor x2 (Se)
3. Cohort Signifer x2 (Si)



Enemy Tactics

Round 1

Cohort Hoplomachus: Approach the nearest non-tank adventurer and attack using **Shield Bash**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Cohort Secutor: Approach the nearest non-tank adventurer and attack using **Barrage**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Cohort Signifer: Attack the most distant adventurer twice using **Thunder**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Round 2

Cohort Hoplomachus: Same as round 1.

Cohort Secutor: Same as round 1.

Cohort Signifer: Attack the most distant adventurer using **Paralyze**, only moving to get into range to attack or to avoid damage. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

On all subsequent rounds, enemies will alternate between the tactics outlined for rounds 1 and 2.

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends when all enemies have been reduced to 0 HP.

ENCOUNTER DATA

COHORT HOPLOMACHUS

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 12

Defense: 16 Magic Defense: 14
Max HP: 50 Speed: 5 squares
STR DEX VIT INT MND
+4 +3 +6 +1 +2

Abilities

Shield Bash Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 9 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

COHORT SECUTOR

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 12

Defense: 14 Magic Defense: 13
Max HP: 45 Speed: 5 squares
STR DEX VIT INT MND
+5 +5 +4 +1 +2

Abilities

Barrage Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Immediately attack three times using **Weaponskill**.

Weaponskill Primary, Physical

Target: Single Range: 1 square

Check: STR (d20 + 5) CR: Target's Defense

Base Effect: Deals 6 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 1d6 damage.



If the adventurers take any imperial soldiers prisoner and interrogate them, they are unable to learn anything new. These are low-ranking soldiers, and are not privy to classified information.

COHORT SIGNIFER

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 15

Defense: 12 Magic Defense: 16
Max HP: 40 Speed: 5 squares
STR DEX VIT INT MND
+1 +3 +2 +6 +5

Abilities

Thunder Primary, Magic, Lightning-Aspected, Invoked

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Deals 7 damage and inflicts a **DOT (5)** on the target. This character can use **Thunder** once more at any point during this turn.

Paralyze Primary, Magic, Invoked

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: Inflicts the **Paralysis** enfeeblement on the target, which has the following effects:

- If a **Paralyzed** character uses a primary ability and rolls a 5 or lower for its ability check, **Paralysis** interrupts the ability, negating it completely. Do not resolve any of its effects, including its base effect. If the interrupted ability has a limited number of uses, none of its uses are consumed and the character may attempt to use the ability again on a later turn.
- **Paralysis** is removed at the end of the **Paralyzed** character's turn.

LITTLE SOLACE FOR LITTLE SOLACE

☞ With a pained grunt and a sickening crunch, your final opponent collapses to the ground in a heap.

You look around and see that Little Solace is littered with the wounded, and those sylphs still able to move are in panicked flight. Several of the camp's structures have been heavily damaged as well, and are in danger of immediate collapse.

The adventurers must attend to the wounded sylphs and help calm the others so they can learn more about what transpired here.

Have each character make one of the following checks. Multiple adventurers may perform the same action if they so desire.

Heal Wounded Sylphs

Any adventurers who choose to tend to the injured sylphs' wounds must make a **MND** check with a CR of 12.

Characters with an ability that restores HP to a single target automatically succeed at this check. Likewise, characters who possess an item which restores HP can use it to ensure a guaranteed success.

Prop Up Damaged Structures

Any adventurers who choose to reinforce the settlement's damaged buildings must make a **STR** check with a CR of 13.

Calm the Panicked Sylphs

Any adventurers who choose to calm the panicked sylphs must make a **MND** or **VIT** check with a CR of 12.

Regardless of success, some semblance of calm does return to Little Solace. However, if at least half of the party succeeded on their checks, the grateful sylphs offer praise for their skillful assistance and present them with a Potion.

Potion Secondary, Consumable
Target: Self
Base Effect: Restores 3 HP to the target. Discard after use.

Once the situation in Little Solace has stabilized, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ Your efforts have restored some semblance of order to the chaos that reigned in Little Solace when you first arrived. But though the sylphs are no longer in panicked flight, they huddle together in tight-knit groups, whispering in fearful voices and glancing nervously over their leafy shoulders. It is clear that they are terrified that the imperial army might return at a moment's notice.

Suddenly, the tension in the air is pierced by a high-pitched shout! Wild-eyed sylphs fearfully zip behind trees and turn somersaults in the air, but calm quickly returns once it becomes obvious that the shout came from an injured sylph who just regained consciousness. That sylph seems agitated, and you approach to see what has them so upset.

Injured Sylph: *Elder one! Where is elder one!?*

Mechanized one was chasing elder one! Elder one acted as decoy and flew off towards the Sylphlands where touched ones remain!

Walking ones! Please! Help elder one!

If the adventurers agree to rescue the sylph elder Frixio, Solquxia accompanies them to act as a guide and ensure they find a safe route through the forest.

THE CAPTIVE ELDER

☞ Solquxia leads you carefully through the Shroud in the direction of the tempered sylphs' territory.

Before you have traveled very far, the high-pitched whine of machinery shatters the relative tranquility of the woods, and you quickly conceal yourselves. Just in the nick of time, too, for moments later a metal beast bursts out of the underbrush with a violent crash! The reports were not mistaken, for what you see resembles nothing more than a massive red scorpion. Your breath catches in your throat—at the end of the scorpion's tail hangs the sylph elder, Frixio, bound and tied.

But the scorpion is not alone. An engineer rides alongside the weapon in a floating magitek conveyor, surveying his surroundings with a satisfied smirk. Recognition dawns quickly—it is Galba lux Pulcher, the imperial officer you encountered in northern Thanalan when you battled the hellscrawl.

Solquxia: *Ghastly! If these ones do not do something, elder one is sure to face a grave fate!*

*Oh! Idea! This one will use **See-Through Magic** on walking ones. Walking ones will become hidden ones, and can rescue elder one without fear of conflict with scary mechanical one.*

*But be warned that **See-Through Magic** will not last long. Sweet-smelling flowers can be sniffed to extend the effect—but only once!*

Without waiting for a response, Solquxia casts a spell and thrusts a Fragrant Blossom into each of your hands.

The adventurers will now be **Obfuscated** at the start of the following encounter.

RESCUE THE ELDER

The players have begun a mini-game. Their goal is to rescue Frixio and transport him to point A, which is marked on the map. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ **Solquxia:** *This one will await your coming over... there! Rescue and escort elder one to this one!*

Solquxia points to a nearby location, marked as point A on the encounter map.

Preparing the Mini-Game

Determine the positions of the enemies and adventurers on the encounter map, then have the players determine their turn order as they would for any other encounter. Before beginning the mini-game, remind them that the purpose of this mini-game is not to fight, but to rescue Frixio.

If any adventurers are visible at the start of the [Enemy Step], they will fail the mini-game and will need to start over from the beginning.

Enemy Turn Order: 1. Cohort Hoplomachus x1 (H)
2. Cohort Secutor x1 (Se)
3. Galba lux Pulcher & Magitek Conveyor x1 (G)
4. Magitek Scorpion x1 (M)

Solquxia is hiding at point A, waiting for the adventurers to deliver Frixio.



Mini-Game Rules

Explain the following rules to the other players:

Rule 1: Obfuscation

The **Obfuscated** effect renders the adventurers invisible to the naked eye and ensures that they cannot be discovered through sight alone. The effect lasts for one round. An adventurer hidden in this way is revealed if they perform any primary actions.

While hidden, the adventurer cannot perform any secondary actions except to use a Fragrant Blossom. Doing so extends the **Obfuscated** effect until the end of the next round, but the blossom is consumed in the process. If the **Obfuscated** effect is lost, the Fragrant Blossom has no effect. Furthermore, the Fragrant Blossoms cannot be transferred to or used on other adventurers.

Rule 2: Rescue Elder Frixio

Elder Frixio can be rescued by any adventurer in an adjacent square who uses a primary action to untie him. Once this is done, Frixio is freed and the adventurer loses the **Obfuscated** effect.

Adventurers can then pick up and carry Frixio as a secondary action, which renders them **Encumbered**.

When an adventurer unties Frixio, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ **Galba:** *You! You're one of those wretched adventurers who foiled me back in Thanalan! You dare interfere with my great work once more!? You DARE oppose the might of the Empire!?*

Galba's face darkens to a scarlet hue, his fury plain as he growls his displeasure.

Rule 3: The Encumbered Status

Any adventurer carrying Frixio becomes **Encumbered**. This status prevents the character from performing any primary actions.

Rule 4: Transporting Frixio

Any adventurer carrying Frixio who arrives at point A can deliver the elder to Solquxia, who ushers him to safety. The player may do so as a free action; no primary or secondary actions are required.

Frixio can also be transferred to an adjacent adventurer by using a secondary action. The character who is now carrying the elder becomes **Encumbered**, and the one who handed him off has that status removed. If the adventurer now carrying Frixio is **Obfuscated**, that status is also removed.

The mini-game is completed when Frixio is conveyed to point A and entrusted to Solquxia.

Rule 5: Imperial Opposition

Any adventurers not **Obfuscated** at the beginning of the [Enemy Step] are detected by the enemy, causing the mini-game to end in failure. If this occurs, return all characters to their initial starting points and restart the mini-game.

Completing the Mini-Game

The mini-game ends when Frixio is conveyed to point A and entrusted to Solquxia. When this occurs, **Obfuscated** is removed from all adventurers, and they lose any remaining Fragrant Blossoms.

All characters retain their current positions on the encounter map, and a combat encounter with the magitek scorpion begins.



Mini-Game FAQs

Q: Can **Obfuscated** adventurers **Sprint**?

A: **Sprint** is considered an action, so they cannot do so without breaking stealth.

Q: Can **Encumbered** adventurers **Sprint**?

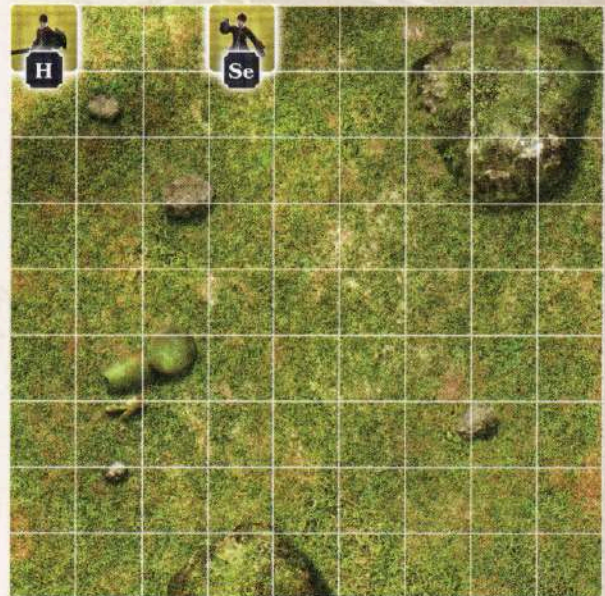
A: They cannot perform primary actions, so no, they cannot.

Q: Can a white mage use **Rescue** on Frixio?

A: Frixio is captive, confused, and unacquainted with the adventurers. Due to these circumstances, he cannot be targeted by **Rescue**.

Q: Can **Rescue** be used on an adventurer **Encumbered** by Frixio?

A: Yes.



Enemy Turn Order:

1. Cohort Hoplomachus x2 (H)
2. Cohort Secutor x2 (Se)
3. Galba lux Pulcher & Magitek Conveyor x1 (G)
4. Magitek Scorpion x1 (M)

CONFRONTING THE MAGITEK SCORPION

Once the players rescue Frixio, the imperials spot them and an encounter begins. The players will have the support of allied sylphs in this encounter.

Galba: Audacious cretins! Again and again you prove most meddlesome!

That ends here! I will squash you like the insects you are, and then crush the Order of the Twin Adder in its entirety! All troops, commence attack!

Galba barks an order to his soldiers, and as one they charge with a fearsome roar. Behind them, you see Galba's magitek conveyor begin to channel aetheric energies!

You must defeat Galba and the magitek scorpion to ensure that this vital phase of Operation Archon ends in success!

Preparing the Encounter (Phase 1)

The position of characters in this encounter is determined by their location at the conclusion of the Rescue the Elder mini-game.

Once the battle starts, a single Cohort hoplomachus and Cohort secutor join the fight as reinforcements. Refer to the diagram for their placement.

At this point in the scenario, the adventurers can use their limit breaks. Make sure to inform the players of this before initiating the encounter.

Encounter Mechanic: Sylphic Support

Once the battle starts, a cadre of sylphs arrives to lend their aid to the adventurers. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

Sylph: A cadre of sylphs suddenly swoops out of the trees to aid you!

Sylph: These ones shall fight steel ones at brave ones' side!

Any time an adventurer makes an ability check during this encounter, they may receive one advantage die on that check. This bonus can be conferred only once per character.



Encounter Timeline

The magitek scorpion and Galba lux Pulcher will act according to the timeline described below.

System messages will also appear at regular intervals, and should be read aloud at the end of their corresponding rounds.

Start of Encounter

Galba lux Pulcher uses **Imperial Will**, generating a marker over the entire map.

🔊 **Galba:** *You will rue the day you raised your hands in opposition to the might of the Garlean Empire!*

System Message: *Charge at 100%! The magitek scorpion is protected by an **Electromagnetic Field**!*

Galba lux Pulcher	Magitek Scorpion
Round 1	
Attack using Revolver , then generate a marker for Pod Strafe .	Attack using Electromagnetic Discharge , then generate a marker for Vertical Tail Laser .
	Electromagnetic Field Deactivated
🔊 System Message: <i>The magitek scorpion discharged its accumulated energy in a violent burst! This discharge has also lowered its Electromagnetic Field!</i>	
Round 2	
Attack using Revolver , then use Initiate Charge .	Attack using Autocannon , then generate a marker for Horizontal Tail Laser .
When Galba uses Initiate Charge :	
🔊 Galba: <i>Fools! Hurry and get the magitek scorpion recharged at once!</i>	
System Message: <i>Current energy charge: 50%!</i>	
Round 3	
	Electromagnetic Field Reactivated
Attack using Revolver , then generate a marker for Mana Burst .	Attack using Autocannon , then generate a marker for Target Search .
🔊 System Message: <i>Charge at 100%! The magitek scorpion is protected by an Electromagnetic Field!</i>	
Round 4+	
On all subsequent rounds, enemies will cycle through the tactics outlined for rounds 1 through 3, in that order.	
Attack using Revolver , then generate a marker for Pod Strafe .	Attack using Electromagnetic Discharge , then generate a marker for Vertical Tail Laser .
	Electromagnetic Field Deactivated
🔊 System Message: <i>The magitek scorpion discharged its accumulated energy in a violent burst! This discharge has also lowered its Electromagnetic Field!</i>	

If Galba is reduced to 0 HP before the magitek scorpion, it can no longer recharge and will lose access to its **Electromagnetic Field**. However, **Electromagnetic Discharge** can still be used by consuming any remaining energy.

Enemy Tactics

Cohort Hoplomachus: Approach the nearest non-tank adventurer and attack using **Shield Bash**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Cohort Secutor: Approach the nearest non-tank adventurer and attack using **Barrage**. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Galba lux Pulcher:

◆ **Revolver:** Target the adventurer with the least HP. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank instead.

Magitek Scorpion:

◆ **Autocannon:** Target two random enemies within range. If a tank has **Enmity** on this character, target the tank and one random enemy within range instead.

ENCOUNTER DATA

COHORT HOPLOMACHUS

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 12

Defense: 16	Magic Defense: 14
Max HP: 50	Speed: 5 squares
STR +4	DEX +3
VIT +6	INT +1
MND +2	

Abilities

Shield Bash	Primary, Physical
Target: Single Range: 1 square	
Check: STR (d20 + 4) CR: Target's Defense	
Base Effect: Deals 9 damage to the target.	
Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.	

COHORT SECUTOR

Size: Medium (1x1) - Spoken

Vigilance: 12

Defense: 14	Magic Defense: 13
Max HP: 45	Speed: 5 squares
STR +5	DEX +5
VIT +4	INT +1
MND +2	

Abilities

Barrage	Primary, Unique
Base Effect: Immediately attack three times using Weaponskill .	
Weaponskill	Primary, Physical
Target: Single Range: 1 square	
Check: STR (d20 + 5) CR: Target's Defense	
Base Effect: Deals 6 damage to the target.	
Direct Hit: Deals an additional 1d6 damage.	

GALBA LUX PULCHER & MAGITEK CONVEYOR

Size: Large (2x2) - Spoken, Forgekin Vigilance: 13

Defense: 14

Magic Defense: 15

Max HP: 250

Speed: 8 squares (flying)

STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+4	+4	+1	+6	+3

Abilities

Imperial Will

Instant

Trigger: At the start of the encounter, immediately before the [Adventurer Step] begins

Base Effect: Immediately attack using **Mana Burst**.

Combo

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Revolver**, then immediately use **Mana Burst**, **Pod Strafe**, or **Initiate Charge**.

Revolver

Primary, Magic

Target: Single Range: 10 squares

Check: INT (d20 + 6) CR: Target's **Magic Defense**

Base Effect: Deals 6 damage to the target.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

INVK Mana Burst

Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic, Invoked

Marker Area: The entire encounter map

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 3d6 damage to all targets.

Hyper-agitates accumulated mana and causes it to violently explode.

INVK Pod Strafe

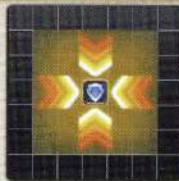
Primary, Mobile Marker, Magic, Invoked

Origin: 1 enemy tank

Marker Area: A mobile 5x5 area centered on the origin that moves with the origin

Target: All enemies within the marker area

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn



Marker Effect: Deals 6d6 damage divided evenly (rounded up) amongst all targets.

Galba launches a swarm of magitek pods that fire powerful laser beams at the targeted area. Trying to bear the brunt of this attack alone would prove unwise—and possibly fatal.

Initiate Charge

Primary, Unique

Target: 1 magitek scorpion Range: 10 squares

Base Effect: At the start of this character's next turn, the target reactivates its **Electromagnetic Field** trait.

MAGITEK SCORPION

Size: Huge (3x3) - Forgekin

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 15

Magic Defense: 14

Max HP: 220

Speed: 6 squares

STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+6	+3	+5	+0	+0

Traits

Elite Foe: Advanced Warmachine

This character cannot be **Stunned** or afflicted with **DOTs**, and markers they have generated cannot be removed. Be sure to inform the players of this before beginning the encounter.

Electromagnetic Field

While active, **Electromagnetic Field** reduces the damage this character takes from all abilities by 10. The effects of this trait are lost after using **Electromagnetic Discharge**, but are restored during the round after Galba lux Pulcher uses **Initiate Charge**.

Abilities

Combo

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Attack using **Autocannon**, then immediately use **Electromagnetic Discharge**, **Target Search**, or **Tail Laser**.

Autocannon

Primary, Physical

Target: 2 characters Range: 6 squares

Check: STR (d20 + 6) CR: Target's **Defense**

Base Effect: Deals 8 damage to all targets.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

Electromagnetic Discharge

Primary, Magic

Target: All enemies on the encounter map

Check: VIT (d20 + 5) CR: Target's **Magic Defense**

Base Effect: Deals 5 damage to all targets. This character loses the effects of the **Electromagnetic Field** trait.

Direct Hit: Deals an additional 2d6 damage.

The magitek scorpion transforms defense into offense by rapidly expanding its protective barrier to blast surrounding foes.

Target Search

Primary, Mobile Marker, Magic

Origin: All enemies within 8 squares of this character

Marker Area: Up to 4 mobile 3x3 areas, one centered on each origin and that move with that origin

Target: All enemies within the marker areas

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn

Marker Effect: Deals 2d6 damage to all targets. In addition, the markers remain in effect until the start of this character's next turn. Any enemies who enter or end their turn within a marker area suffer 5 damage.



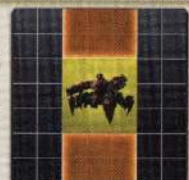
Tail Laser

Primary, Stationary Marker, Magic

Marker Area: Two stationary 3x6 areas extending in straight lines from three adjacent squares that are adjacent to and on opposite sides of this character

Target: All enemies within the marker areas

Marker Trigger: The beginning of this character's next turn



Marker Effect: Deals 6d6 damage to all targets.

The magitek scorpion simultaneously attacks in two opposite directions with its mounted autocannon and tail laser.

Transitioning to Phase 2

The encounter transitions to its second phase once Galba lux Pulcher has been reduced to 0 HP. This occurs either at the end of the [Adventurer Step] or the [Enemy Step], whichever comes first.

Cutscene

Severely wounded by your attacks, Galba collapses into a heap atop his magitek conveyor.

Galba: *Urk...! How could I have let myself be defeated by you wretched Eorzean rats? No matter what happens, I cannot allow imperial technology to fall into your filthy hands. You leave me no other choice!*

With trembling hands, Galba manipulates something on the conveyor's controls, and the magitek scorpion begins to emit a cacophonous warning sound.

WARNING! WARNING! This unit will self-destruct! Please evacuate the area immediately. Initiating countdown to explosive discharge: 3...

Galba: *Gahaha! The magitek scorpion will raze this entire area to smoldering ruin! GLORY TO THE EMPIRE!*

Solquxia: *This is terrible! If mechanized one explodes, Little Solace and the wood alike will suffer a terrible fate! What are these ones to do!?*

With its self-destruct mode engaged, the magitek scorpion ceases its furious attacks. Instead, it begins to vibrate, slowly at first, but then faster and faster, warning alarms blaring all the while.

Countdown to explosive discharge: 2...

You must destroy the warmachina before it can self-destruct and blow the Twelveswood sky-high—and you along with it!

Preparing the Encounter (Phase 2)

Remove all characters other than the adventurers and the magitek scorpion from the encounter map.

This phase ends after completing the [Adventurer Step] in round 2.

During phase 2, the magitek scorpion is a special character with no HP, but you still need to keep track of the damage it takes. Once it has been dealt 100 or more damage, read the following passage aloud for the other players:

With a sharp crack, a rent opens in the magitek scorpion's core. The accumulated electromagnetic energy begins to safely dissipate through this gap, but you're not out of danger yet. The warmachina continues its self-destruct sequence!

After the [Adventurer Step] in the second round concludes, calculate the total damage dealt to the magitek scorpion. Then, follow the instructions in the corresponding section below.

150+ Damage

The magitek scorpion explodes before it can use **Self-Destruct**. The adventurers are victorious!

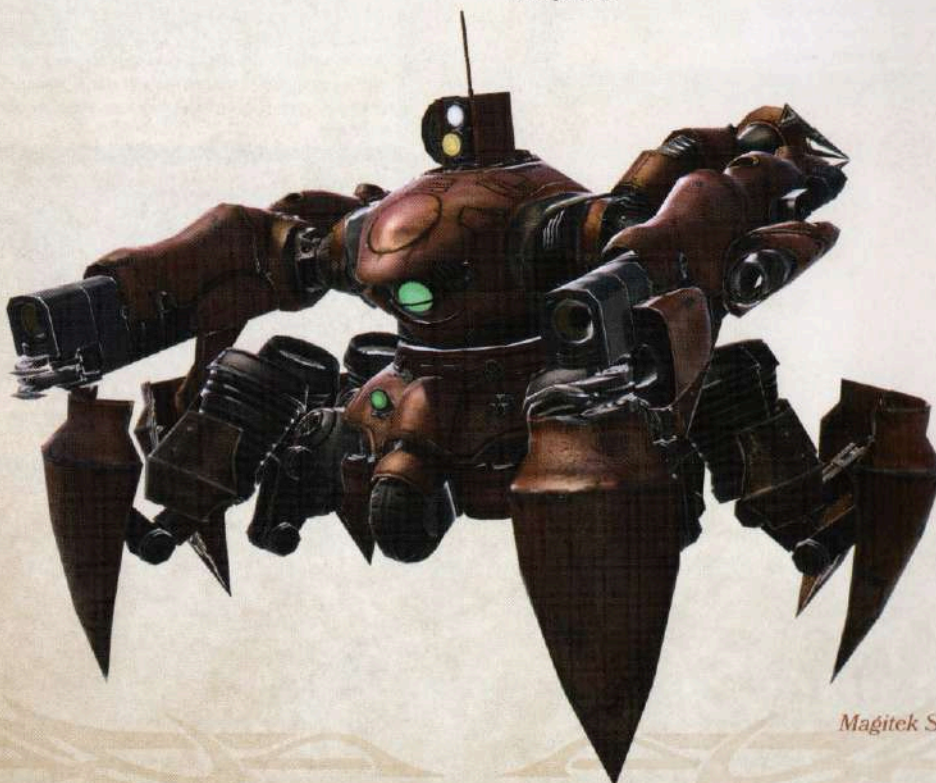
100-149 Damage

The magitek scorpion immediately uses **Self-Destruct**, dealing 12d6 damage to each adventurer. The explosion is relatively small, however, and there is no damage to the surrounding area. If even one adventurer is left standing after the explosion, they eke out a narrow victory.

Less than 100 Damage

The magitek scorpion detonates in a massive explosion, **Knocking Out** the adventurers and leaving a massive, smoking crater in the eastern reaches of the Black Shroud.

If the players desire, the scenario can be restarted in its entirety, from the start of this encounter, or from the start of this phase.



Magitek Scorpion

ENCOUNTER DATA

MAGITEK SCORPION - SELF-DESTRUCT MODE

Size: Huge (3x3) - Forgekin

Vigilance: 10

Defense: 15

Magic Defense: 15

Max HP: Special

Speed: —

STR	DEX	VIT	INT	MND
+6	+3	+5	+0	+0

Abilities

Countdown (Round 1 Only)

Primary, Unique

Base Effect: Read the following passage aloud for the other players.

System Message: Countdown to explosive discharge: 1...

Self-Destruct

Primary, Physical

Target: All enemies on the encounter map

Base Effect: Deals 12d6 damage to all targets.

Limitation: Cannot be used during round 1

Ending the Encounter

The encounter ends after the second round's [Adventurer Step]. If the party is successful in limiting the destructive potential of the magitek scorpion's **Self-Destruct**, read the following passage aloud for the other players, adjusting as needed if any adventurers were **Knocked Out** in the encounter or ensuing explosion:

🔊 The magitek scorpion explodes, sending out a fiery blast that shakes the Shroud. Thanks to your unflagging efforts, the warmachina was unable to accumulate enough power to fully self-destruct, rendering its final act of destruction far less potent than intended. You and the sylphs are safe—if a little shell-shocked—and you have done your part to hamper the Empire's ambitions!

Galba lux Pulcher, however, was less fortunate—he was hovering just above the magitek scorpion when it exploded, and there remains not a trace of the man. With your foes defeated, it would be best to let the Order of the Twin Adder's forces take over from here. Filled with pride over your hard-won victory, you make your way back to rejoin the main contingent of adventurers heading for Castrum Meridianum. It's time to see Operation Archon through to its conclusion.

Galba lux Pulcher



THE BULL OF ALA MHIGO

The players rejoin the main contingent of adventurers just as the assault on the Praetorium is launched. Read the following passage aloud for the other players:

☞ You leave the Black Shroud and rejoin the main contingent of adventurers, arriving moments before the final thrust of Operation Archon begins. The Eorzean Alliance's forces have taken up position near Camp Bluefog, in the very shadow of the Praetorium.

Just as you arrive, Raubahn Aldynn, leader of the Immortal Flames, stands before the assembled Allied forces and begins to deliver a speech.

Raubahn: *Greetings, heroes of Eorzea! I am Flame General Raubahn Aldynn. Hear me now, my comrades! Take heart, for with each drop of blood you've shed, you have paved the way to victory and a free Eorzea! Your courage saw us through the third phase of Operation Archon, and carried us to the enemy's very gates!*

Loud cheers erupt from the mass of soldiers and adventurers. Raubahn raises his hands and motions the crowd to quiet before continuing:

Raubahn: *However, the true battle yet lies ahead. Now we march on the Praetorium! Let it be known that we will crush the Garlean forces! We will emerge victorious!*

Raubahn throws his head back and lets loose a ferocious bellow, eliciting a tide of whoops and shouts from the assembled army.

Amidst the cheering ranks, you spot a familiar face: Second Serpent Commander Louixon. She stands at the head of the unit of serpent soldiers you are meant to join for the assault, and with her are Solquxia and the sylph auxiliaries.

You approach to take your positions, and Louixon welcomes you with much enthusiasm.

Louixon: *Full glad am I to see all of you returned safely! And what's more, you've laid low the Empire's latest mechanized monstrosity. We can now fight alongside our sylphic allies without need to look over our shoulders!*

Solquxia: *This one offers humble thanks for brave ones rescuing elder one and protecting these ones' home. And now, these ones shall fight at walking ones' side!*

Cellica Flame sees that you have taken your position and approaches to offer her own words of praise.

Cellica: *Welcome back. I have already heard tell of your brave deeds today. It would be little exaggeration to say your efforts have almost single-handedly ensured that we were successful in cutting off reinforcements from Castrum Oriens. You have my deepest thanks, brave heroes!*

In the coming moments, Operation Archon will move into its final phase, and the climactic battle for the Praetorium will begin.

Future historians will write that it was this day that marked the beginning of the Garlean Empire's decline, and a new dawn for the realm of Eorzea.



Cellica Flame

The Praetorium



Thanks to your valor, the Empire's new weapon was destroyed and Galba lux Pulcher's ambitions were crushed along with him. Adventurers who have completed Scenario 1: A Crystal Caper, Scenario 2: Imperial Machinations, and Scenario 3: Heroes of Operation Archon will earn the title "Galba's Bane." This title has no discernable effect at this time.

However, the battle for a free Eorzea does not end here. As Raubahn made plain, the final phase of Operation Archon has yet to take place. If you would like to continue this adventure,

consider referring to the Final Fantasy XIV main scenario quest *The Ultimate Weapon* to create your own conclusion to this epic struggle. And of course, much like this scenario, you are welcome to create a fresh take on the story—one in which your adventurers play an active role in the events of Final Fantasy XIV.

Countless adventures await you in the realm of Eorzea, so venture forth and seek them out with trusted friends and allies at your side! Your journey has only just begun.

TO BE CONTINUED...





CHAPTER 5: CONTINUING THE STORY

FINISHING A SCENARIO

When your group reaches the end of the scenario, your adventure comes to a close. Take a moment to celebrate—you and your adventurers deserve it!

Of course, finishing a scenario is hardly the end of your journey. The Starter Set includes three interconnected scenarios which come together to form one overarching story. Assuming your group enjoyed the level 30 scenario, you can continue your game with the level 40 scenario, and then see the story to its epic conclusion in the level 50 scenario.

Handling Party Defeat

An adventurer's life is full of danger. One unlucky turn too many, and they can easily find themselves **Knocked Out**. If all party members are reduced to 0 HP, the party is defeated. Some scenarios include directions for dealing with this situation, but if yours does not, talk with the other players and decide how your group wants to handle it.

Typically, you'll want to choose from among the following options, but your group is welcome to come up with exciting or amusing alternatives instead.

1. Retry the Encounter

Retrying from the beginning of an encounter will let players anticipate the actions their enemies may take, resulting in a better chance of victory.

When a party wipes during a boss battle or similarly challenging encounter, you can also lower the difficulty by restoring the adventurers' HP and MP and allowing them to retry from the beginning of the phase.

Retrying an encounter can be time-consuming. If you're nearing the end of your session, it may be best to quicksave and try again the next time you play.

2. Restart the Scenario

Scenarios are often shaped by the adventurers' actions, and encounters and endings may change depending on the choices that they make. As such, your group can choose to take a party wipe as an opportunity to begin the scenario anew.

It goes without saying that this will take even longer than retrying a single encounter, so you may want to wait until your next session before starting over.

If your group wants to play another scenario, find a day that works for everyone and schedule your next game session. Be sure to leave yourself enough time to prepare!

You may also want to trade roles with one of the other players, too. That will give them a chance to try GMing, and you the experience of playing as an adventurer. Just remember not to read the next scenario if you intend to be an adventurer, or you'll spoil the surprise!

3. Improvise

Improvising solutions on the fly might seem like a daunting task, but you can always plan for situations like this in advance. For example, here's a good trick to keep up your sleeve:

GM: *Just when things are looking grim for the party, help arrives in the nick of time and revives the fallen adventurers!*

Look at that! An ally swoops in to save the day, and the adventurers recover just enough to continue the fight. It's up to you how much HP the adventurers regain, but you can always default to half of their **Max HP**, rounded up.

When using this option, you may want to come up with narrative reasons to make it more compelling for the other players. Perhaps an NPC the party helped earlier in the story appeared to repay a previous kindness, or an enemy decided to show mercy (or contempt) and let the party live.

You'll also need to think of a reason for their newfound health. White magic, Potions, or even time bought through a well-placed distraction could explain how the adventurers survived a seemingly lethal encounter.

4. Skip the Encounter

If you're running short on time, you can always choose to advance the story as if the adventurers had won the encounter.

Take care not to overuse this option, as skipping encounters can defeat the purpose of the game. There's nothing wrong with dialogue-focused stories if players are looking to roleplay, but encounters in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG also make up a key part of the narrative. Leaving the outcome of player choices to chance can take the story in unexpected and exciting directions, and can even create fresh opportunities for roleplay.

Unlike many other games, the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG doesn't use experience points to level up the player characters. When starting a new scenario, players can either prepare new adventurer sheets of the appropriate level, or level up their existing adventurers to match the scenario's level.

If a player chooses to continue playing as the same adventurer, have them write down the name of any scenarios they've completed in their profile so they can keep track of their character's exploits and experiences.

DOWNTIME BETWEEN ADVENTURES

It's likely that a good deal of time will pass on Hydaelyn between the end of one scenario and the beginning of another. It's also just as likely that the adventurers won't spend all of this time sitting idle. They might take on work as a Disciple of the Hand or Land, enjoy games of chance at the Gold Saucer, or assist the Grand Companies with their efforts.

The way adventurers choose to spend their downtime can even have an impact on the next scenario you play. For those who are interested in learning how to handle character downtime between adventures, more information can be found in the Standard Rulebook.



CONFIDENCE MAKES THE GM

When running a game, nothing will serve you better than confidence. As the GM, the players are counting on you to take them on an incredible adventure. If you seem unsure of yourself, the players might get anxious about the future of your group.

Remember that the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG is just a game, and making a few mistakes won't bring about the next Umbral Calamity. So what if you need to take your time and flip through the scenario or rulebook to look something up now and again? As long as you're doing your best to ensure the players are having fun with the scenario, you're playing the game right.

The real magic of roleplaying games comes from within your imagination; the rules and scenarios are just there to help you along the way. If you're worried your group won't enjoy an encounter, skip it. If a rule is slowing things down, replace it with a rule of your own.

You are the gamemaster—storyteller and arbiter of adventure. So believe in yourself, run the game to the best of your abilities, and above all, have a good time.





FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

For easier reference, you may wish to print out copies of the Adventurer FAQs (pages 64 - 65) and the FAQs for individual jobs (pages 65 - 66) to distribute to your players.

ADVENTURER FAQs

Q. How do I earn experience points and level up?

A. The concept of experience points does not exist in the Final Fantasy XIV TTRPG. Instead, your character's level is adjusted to match the recommended level of each scenario you undertake. Think of it as a sort of level sync system.

Q. Where can I find information on my adventurer's equipment?

A. This game assumes your adventurer is already outfitted with equipment appropriate to their job and level, and has factored this into their attributes. This way, you won't have to spend your hard-earned gil or complete sidequests to outfit your adventurer each time you level them up. As such, this book does not contain specific info for weapons or armor.

Q. Should I keep track of adventuring supplies—waterskins, rations, torches, rope, lockpicks, and so forth—in my adventurer's inventory?

A. You can assume your adventurer keeps any supplies they need on hand, so you don't need to worry about keeping track of them. More information on this can be found in the Standard Rulebook.

Q. Say my adventurer is exploring a cave. Do they need to be carrying a torch in order to see? If so, what happens to the torch when they draw their weapons at the start of an encounter?

A. As a general rule, you don't need to worry about lighting in this game. Assume that your adventurer is always capable of seeing the area around them, unless otherwise specified. If, however, a scenario specifies that an area is dark or foggy and limits visibility, defer to the rules outlined in the scenario.

Q. Does my adventurer have a company chocobo or any other mounts?

A. Yes, they do. As long as your GM approves, you are free to have your adventurer ride atop any mount you like.

Q. Am I allowed to replay a scenario I've already completed?

A. Yes, you are more than welcome to do so. While you'll already be familiar with the story, playing as a different role may well provide a fun new experience.

If, however, you replay a scenario with a group that includes first-time players, it is common courtesy to avoid spoiling the scenario's story. In addition to avoiding comments about the ending or upcoming plot points, you should also be careful not to let your expression give anything away. If you're concerned this might prove difficult, consider replaying the scenario with players who have already completed it.

Q. Say I roll a 20 for a **STR** check to lift a chocobo carriage. Does this mean my adventurer automatically succeeds?

A. Unfortunately, no. While a 20 rolled for an ability check results in a critical, the same does not apply for other checks.

Q. How many squares of movement does it take to move diagonally?

A. Moving into an adjacent square—including squares that are diagonally adjacent—costs one square of movement.

Q. If I wanted to move my adventurer diagonally around a corner like in Diagram A, or around an enemy like in Diagram B, how many squares of movement will this cost me?

A. Moving into a diagonally adjacent square that is unoccupied will always cost one square of movement unless the scenario, an encounter mechanic, a trait, or an ability states otherwise.



Q. How can I tell which way an enemy is facing during an encounter? Do I get some kind of advantage when attacking from behind?

A. This game does not keep track of the direction characters are facing, and as such, no special advantages are conferred when attacking from specific positions. Encounters are hectic situations in which friend and foe jockey for position, so you may assume that your adventurer is always attacking from the most advantageous direction when using abilities.

Q. Do I need to worry about hurting my allies when using abilities that deal damage?

A. Unless otherwise stated, your abilities will not deal damage to allied characters.

Q. Are weaponskills considered to be abilities?

A. To prevent the rules from becoming overly complex, most of the actions available to characters during encounters are classified as abilities. Limit breaks—as well as enemy actions that generate markers—are also considered to be abilities.

Q. If I focus instead of performing a standard movement, can I use the same *secondary* ability twice in a single turn?

A. Unless otherwise stated, you are free to use a given *secondary* ability more than once, assuming you're able to perform multiple secondary actions on your turn. The same is true for *primary* abilities.

- Q. Can I use the same ability to apply multiple instances of an enhancement or enfeeblement to a single target?
- A. No, a given character cannot use the same ability or trait to apply multiple instances of an enhancement or enfeeblement to a single target. However, multiple characters can apply separate instances of an enhancement or enfeeblement to a single target using the same ability or trait.

Example 1: Even if Warrior A (Lv. 30) uses **Berserk** twice in a single turn, their abilities would only deal an additional 2 damage, not an additional 4 damage.

Example 2: Even if Black Mage A (Lv. 30) uses **Thunder** twice on Goblin Mugger A, they only inflict a single instance of **DOT (3)**.

Example 3: Black Mage A (Lv. 30) and Black Mage B (Lv. 30) each use **Thunder** on Goblin Mugger A. As the enfeeblements were inflicted by different characters, Goblin Mugger A would suffer from two separate instances of **DOT (3)**.

Example 4: Even if Black Mage A (Lv. 30) uses **Thunder** and **Thunder II** on Goblin Mugger A, they only inflict a single instance of **DOT (3)** because of the **Thaumaturgic Shock** trait.

- Q. Can a warrior's **Low Blow** and a dragoon's **Leg Sweep** be used to **Stun** a single enemy twice during an encounter?
- A. No, they cannot. While they are two different abilities, their base effect descriptions state that any characters they **Stun** cannot be **Stunned** again during the encounter.
- Q. My party took an enemy by surprise. If they can't act on their turn during round 1, do they still take damage from **DOTs**?
- A. Yes, they do. While surprised enemies cannot act on their turns, the round still includes an enemy step. As such, any **DOTs** inflicted are resolved as usual when that step ends.
- Q. When exactly is an *instant* ability resolved if its trigger states "immediately before an ability is resolved"?
- A. It would be resolved just before **8. [Resolve Effects]** in the Ability Resolution outlined on page 29 of the Player Book. In other words, the *instant* ability is resolved after confirming the effects of—and rolling any dice for—the ability that triggered it, but before that ability itself is resolved.
- Q. Does a **Stunned** enemy take a -5 penalty to **Defense** and **Magic Defense**?
- A. This penalty only applies to checks made by the **Stunned** character. **Defense** and **Magic Defense** are secondary attributes, and as such, they are not affected by the penalty.
- Q. What happens to a character's enhancements and enfeeblements when they are **Knocked Out**?
- A. All enhancements and enfeeblements are removed when a character is **Knocked Out**.
- Q. Is there a way to damage enemies without using abilities, akin to Final Fantasy XIV's auto-attack?
- A. No, you must use abilities in order to deal damage.

- Q. Is there a limit to the number of advantage dice I can roll at any given time?
- A. No, you may roll however many advantage dice your GM chooses to award you.

WARRIOR FAQs

- Q. If I inflict **Enmity** on a foe, does it last for the duration of the encounter?
- A. No, **Enmity** is removed at the end of the afflicted enemy's turn.
- Q. If an enemy moves out of range after I hit them with **Overpower**, is the **Enmity** it inflicted removed?
- A. No, **Enmity** remains even if the enemy moves out of range.
- Q. My level 30 warrior used **Overpower**, but didn't score a direct hit. If I used **Berserk** before **Overpower**, does it deal damage?
- A. As **Overpower**'s base effect doesn't deal any damage, the additional damage from **Berserk** would not apply.
- Q. I wanted to use **Provoke** at the start of an enemy's turn, but the GM announced the enemy's actions before I could say so. Can we retcon this so I can use **Provoke**?
- A. The GM would have the final say in the matter, but if you explain the situation to the other players, there's nothing wrong with jumping back to the start of the enemy's turn. That said, if the enemy has already finished their turn, or if several effects have already been resolved, it would be best to leave things as they are.
- Q. Can I use **Low Blow** to **Stun** a boss?
- A. You can use **Low Blow** to **Stun** a boss just like you would any other enemy. However, some bosses have traits or other effects that prevent them from being **Stunned**.
- Q. Are markers removed when I use **Low Blow** to **Stun** a target returned to the encounter map when **Stun** wears off at the end of my turn?
- A. Once a marker is removed from the encounter map, it does not return, unless otherwise stated.

DRAGOON FAQs

- Q. I used my limit break, **Dragonsong Dive**, to move out of range just before the effects of an enemy's ability were resolved. Does their ability still affect me?
- A. No, it does not. If you are not a valid target at the moment an ability's effects are resolved, it does not affect you.

BLACK MAGE FAQs

- Q. Say a level 50 black mage uses **Fire** and rolls an 11 on the ability check. Adding their **INT** would bring the total to 16. Does **Firestarter** proc?
- A. No, the unmodified d20 roll and not the modified total is what determines if a proc effect is triggered. **Firestarter** only procs if you roll a 16 or higher.

Q. Are penalties applied to the d20 roll made to see if **Thundercloud** procs when a **DOT** inflicted by **Thunder** deals damage?

A. No, the unmodified d20 roll and not the modified total is what determines if a proc effect is triggered.

Q. Can I use **Thunder** and **Thunder II** to inflict two separate **DOTs** on a single target?

A. No, you cannot. The **Thaumaturgic Shock** trait prevents **DOTs** inflicted by your *thunder spell* abilities from stacking.

Q. Do I make two separate rolls to see if a proc effect triggers for **Thunder** and **Thunder II**?

A. Yes, you do. As they are different abilities, you would roll once when **Thunder**'s **DOT** deals damage, and again when **Thunder II**'s **DOT** deals damage.

Q. If I used **Thunder** to inflict **DOTs** on two different enemies, how many times do I roll to see if **Thundercloud** procs?

A. At the end of the [Enemy Step], regardless of how many separate **DOTs** inflicted by **Thunder** deal damage, you would only roll a d20 once. The same is true for **DOTs** inflicted by **Thunder II**.

WHITE MAGE FAQs

Q. Can I use **Esuna** to remove **Prone**?

A. Yes, you can. **Esuna** is able to remove any enfeeblement that doesn't explicitly state that it cannot be removed in its description.

WHITE MAGE & BLACK MAGE FAQs

Q. Can I use **Swiftcast** at the end of my own turn?

A. You can, yes. Keep in mind that because **Swiftcast** would be resolved before your turn ends, you still benefit from any ongoing effects that last until the end of your turn.

Q. If I use **Swiftcast** at the end of another adventurer's turn and that adventurer is last in the turn order, do I recover MP before I act?

A. No, you do not. Adventurers recover MP at the end of the [Adventurer Step], before the [Enemy Step] begins. As **Swiftcast** is resolved before the [Adventurer Step] ends, the [Adventurer Step] is still ongoing and you will not have recovered MP.

GAMEMASTER FAQs

Q. The scenario's enemy tactics section states that if a tank has **Enmity** on an enemy character, I should target the tank. However, there are no unoccupied squares adjacent to the tank, so I can't get close enough to attack. What should I do?

A. Ultimately, this would come down to your judgment as the GM. You could, for example, choose to attack another adventurer, or move as close to the tank as possible without attacking. Remember, enemy characters can **Sprint** as their primary action. Don't forget that if a tank has **Enmity** on an enemy, that enemy incurs a -5 penalty on all ability checks that don't target the tank.

Q. An enemy that a tank has **Enmity** on uses an ability that targets multiple adventurers. If the tank is one of those targets, does the enemy incur a -5 penalty?

A. So long as they are also targeting the tank with the same ability, the enemy would not incur a penalty on the ability checks made against other targeted adventurers.

Q. Do I need to tell players when an enemy uses an *invoked* ability?

A. Yes, you do. When you announce the name of the ability an enemy is using, be sure to let the players know if it is *invoked*.

Q. How should I use the two types of markers included in the Starter Set?

A. There are no specific rules as to how the included markers should be used. You can even create your own original markers if doing so would improve your group's experience. So long as all players are aware of what a given marker represents, there is no wrong way to use a marker.

To give you a few ideas, you could place two corner markers on the encounter map to represent the two opposite corners of a large square or rectangular marker area without having to move any character tokens present inside it.

Tile markers, on the other hand, can be handy when an ability or effect generates a marker that covers a specific area of the encounter map. If a character token is present within the marker area when a marker is generated, remove the token, place the marker, then return the token to the encounter map.

The ● and ✕ icons on the included markers are simply there to help you distinguish one marker from another. For example, if Enemy A and Enemy B use abilities that generate markers, you could use markers with the ● icon for Enemy A and markers with the ✕ icon for Enemy B.

INDEX

PL: PLAYER BOOK
GM: GAMEMASTER BOOK

A

Abilities.....PL20, PL26, PL29
 Ability Checks.....PL27, PL28
 Adjacent Squares.....PL27
 Advantage Dice.....PL9, PL18, PL19, PL28, GM15, GM65
 Adventurers.....PL16, PL20
 [Adventurer Step].....PL23
 Aetherytes.....GM11, GM17
 Allies.....PL16, PL27
 Attributes.....PL21
 Auto-Attack.....GM65

B

Barriers.....PL31
 Base Effect.....PL28
 Bells.....GM16
 Blind.....PL33
 Brink of Death.....PL34

C

Centered On.....PL27
 Challenge Rating.....PL17
 Challenge Rating Reference Table.....PL17
 Characters.....PL16
 Checks.....PL17, PL27, PL28, GM14
 Colossal (Size).....PL26
 Comatose.....PL34
 Combo Abilities.....PL24
 Companions.....GM6, GM7
 Consumables.....GM11
 Cost.....PL26, PL32
 CR.....PL17, PL27
 Creator.....PL29
 Critical.....PL14, PL28

D

d (Abbreviation).....PL16
 Damage Over Time.....PL33
 Death.....PL32, PL34
 Defeat.....GM62
 Defense.....PL21, PL27
 DEX.....PL21
 Diagonal Movement.....PL24, GM64
 Dice.....PL16, PL28
 Direct Hit.....PL12, PL28
 DOT.....PL33, GM66
 DPS.....PL11, PL20

E

Elemental Hours.....GM16
 Encounters.....PL23
 Encounter Map.....PL23
 [End of Round Step].....PL23
 Enemies.....PL16, PL27
 [Enemy Step].....PL23
 Enfeeblements.....PL31, PL33
 Enhancements.....PL31, PL33
 Enmity.....GM65, GM66
 Equipment.....GM64

F

Factions.....PL23
 Focus.....PL24
 Free Actions.....PL24

G

Gamemaster.....PL16
 Gil.....GM11
 GM.....PL16, GM4, GM63

H

Healers.....PL11, PL20
 HP.....PL31, PL32
 Huge (Size).....PL26

I

Instant.....PL25, PL26
 INT.....PL21
 Invoked.....GM66
 Items.....GM11

J

Jobs.....PL20

K

Knocked Out.....PL32, PL34

L

Large (Size).....PL26
 Level.....PL20, GM64
 Limitation.....PL28
 Limit Breaks.....PL15, PL32
 Linkpearls.....GM11

M

Magic.....PL26
 Magic Defense.....PL21, PL27
 Markers.....PL29, PL30, GM11, GM66
 Marker Area.....PL30
 Marker Effect.....PL30
 Marker Trigger.....PL30
 Max HP.....PL21, PL31
 Max MP.....PL21, PL32
 Medium (Size).....PL20, PL26
 MND.....PL21
 Mobile Markers.....PL30
 Monsters.....PL16
 Mounts.....GM64
 Movement Effects.....PL25
 MP.....PL32
 Multiple Targets.....PL28

N

Natural MP Recovery.....PL32
 Non-Player Characters.....PL16
 NPCs.....PL16

O

Occupied Squares.....PL26
 Opposition Checks.....PL19
 Origin.....PL30

P

Party.....PL20
 Penalties.....PL18, PL19
 Phases.....PL31
 Physical.....PL26
 Players.....PL16
 Player Characters.....PL16
 Primary (Ability).....PL24, PL26
 Primary Actions.....PL24, PL26
 Primary Attributes.....PL21
 Proc Effects.....PL29, GM66
 Profile.....PL22
 Prone.....PL26, PL33, GM66

Q

Quicksaving.....GM10

R

Race.....PL4
 Range.....PL27
 Requirement.....PL26
 Rest.....GM17
 Roles.....PL20
 Roleplaying.....GM13
 Rounds.....PL23

S

Scenarios.....PL16, GM8, GM10, GM62
 Scenario & Gamemaster Guide.....GM9
 Secondary (Ability).....PL24, PL26
 Secondary Actions.....PL24, PL26
 Secondary Attributes.....PL21
 Self.....PL27
 Size.....PL20, PL26
 Sleep.....GM17
 Slow.....PL33
 Small (Size).....PL26
 Source.....PL29
 Special (d20).....PL27, PL28
 Speed.....PL21, PL24
 Sprint.....PL24
 Squares.....PL24
 Standard Movement.....PL24, PL25
 Standard Rulebook.....GM9
 Starter Set.....GM8
 Stationary Markers.....PL30
 Steps.....PL23
 STR.....PL21
 Stun.....PL34, GM65
 Surprise.....PL24

T

Tanks.....PL20
 Targets (Ability).....PL27
 Targets (Marker).....PL30
 Teleporting.....GM11, GM17
 Titles.....PL22
 Total.....PL17
 Traits.....PL20, PL31
 Travel.....GM17
 Turns.....PL24
 Turn Order.....PL23, PL31
 Type (Ability).....PL26
 Type (Marker).....PL30

U

Unique.....PL26

V

Vigilance.....PL21
 VIT.....PL21

W

Weakness.....PL32, PL34

CRED

Producer: Ken'ichi Fujita (H)

Game Designer / Lead Writer: Yoshiyuk

Project Manager: Eiji Nakabayas

Planners: Shun Yamada, Teruaki Sh

Editor: Asako Seo (HOB)

Promotion: Yuichiro Aida (H)

Sales: Akira Ueda (HOB)

Graphic Design / Layout: Akira Tanaka, Makito Naka

Scenarios: FarEast Amuse

Yura Kubota Takuji Endo A

Hiroshi Wa

Map Illustrations: S

Hiroshi Sugano Hiroyuki Soejima

Comic: Yousuke Adachi (S)

English Translation: Elizabeth Bushouse

English Localization Di

Supervision: Squar

The FINAL FANTASY XIV Deve

The FINAL FANTAS

Flanna Borgeson-Leake Juan Centurion

Executive Producer: Takefumi Ichir

Special Thanks (Alp

FINAL FANTASY XIV Produce

Amisa Sakuragi

Appi

Bunbunmaru

Chloe Captivate [Aegis]

cta

D.C.

Donburi

Edosan

Ei Mochizuki

Elezen Ojisan

Elle Starlit [Bahamut]

Evangeline

fan114

Fighter-KOU

Furnito Fujita

ichiru

Juushimatsu Juushoku

kankan

Kei Yamaguchi

Kimihiro Fujino

Koroku Alexander

Liah Liddell [Ixion]

Makiko

MaMa San

Masahide Kawaguchi

Mashiro Pastel [Bahamut]

Itsuki Miyazaki, Koji Ito, Ko Okada, Syunsuke Okabe, Yutak

FINAL FANTASY XIV TT

First Edition Publi

Produced by SQUARE ENIX CO., LTD

SHINJUKU EASTSIDE SQUARE 6-27-30 Shi

Official Website: <https://www.sq>

For inquiries about

UK

SQUARE ENIX LIMITED Merchandising Department

240 Blackfriars Road, London SE1 8NW, UK

Customer Support: <https://support.eu.square-enix.com/>

USA

SQUARE ENIX, LLC. Merc

999 N. Pacific Coast Hwy, Suite 150

Customer Support: <https://support.us.square-enix.com/>

Planning / Distribution: H

SQUARE ENIX

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a re
electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or other

Permission is given to copy the chara

MADE IN

© SQUARE

LOGO ILLUSTRATION: ©20

DITS

HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

i Fushimi (HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

hi (HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

imizu (HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

BY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

BY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

mura, Yasuhiro Sasaki (HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

ment Research Co.,Ltd.

kira Ohata Taketoshi Tando

atanabe

OESOE STUDIO

Takeshi Nishimura takuji

udio Encount Co., Ltd.)

Samuel J Allen Stephen Meyerink

rector: Gavin Greene

re Enix Co., Ltd.

velopment & Operations Team

SY XIV QA Team

Christopher Galvan Emma Williams

nohe (HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

phabetical Order):

er & Director Naoki Yoshida

Mayumi Sekizawa

Mayu Okumura

Mimi Zokku [Aegis]

Mirin Furukawa (Dempagumi.inc)

Moki

Motiya Ellroy

nyancof

NZM

Oshino Pepe

pekos

Rappa86

Rubystar Redheart

Saika Fujino

Sakura Ogsun [Aegis]

SHIDEN

Shinnosuke Tachibana

Sirou Heartnet [Aegis]

snaping_s

Takumayan

Taro Ito

Tomoyo After [Aegis]

Walkichi

yasutia

Youhei-Penguin

Yousuke Adachi

Yu Kitada

ka Seki, Yusuke Yanagisawa (HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.)

RPG STARTER SET

shed May 2024

. Merchandising Business Division

injuku, Shinjuku-ku, Tokyo 160-8430, Japan

uare-enix-shop.com/ffxivtrpg/

at this product:

EU

SQUARE ENIX GmbH

Domstrasse 17, 20095 Hamburg, Germany

Customer Support: <https://support.eu.square-enix.com/>

chandising Department

, El Segundo, CA 90245 U.S.A.

://sqex.to/mdsupport

HOBBY JAPAN CO., LTD.

K[®]



etrieval system, or transmitted in any form by any means,
rwise without the prior permission of the publishers.
acter sheets for personal use only.

JAPAN

E ENIX

10 YOSHITAKA AMANO